N3 An Adventure for 4-6 Characters, Levels 1-4 9163

Advanced Dungeons & Dragons®

Official Game Adventure

Destiny of Kings

Stephen Bourne

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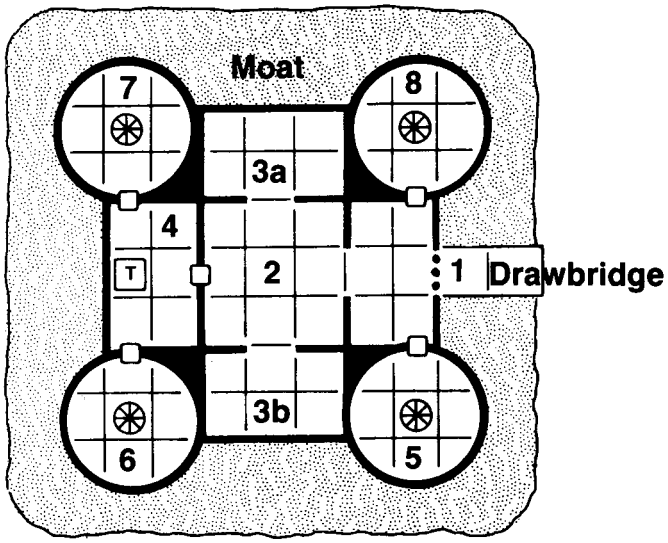
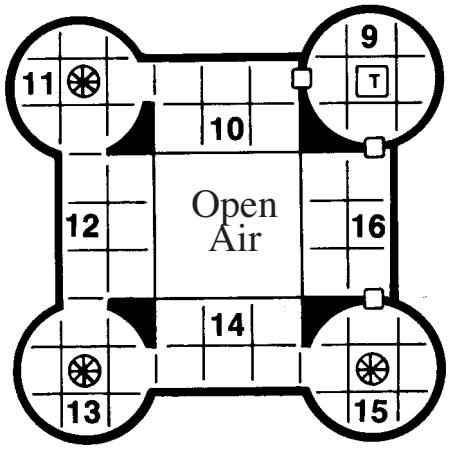
Map 8: Capel Tower

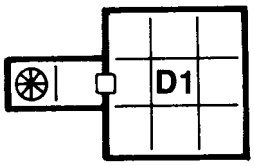
Ground Level



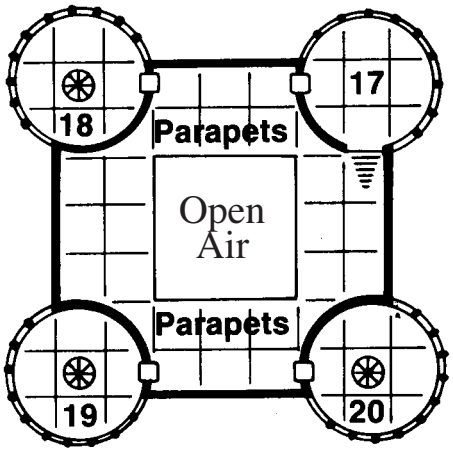
Level II

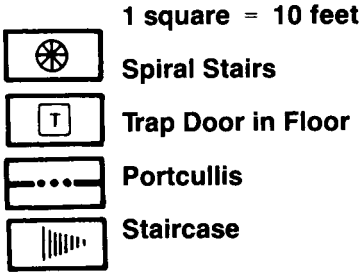


Dungeon (lower) Level



Level III





Note: trap doors in ceilings of 18, 19, and 20 lead to open parapets above. Staircase leads to parapets above 17.

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OFFICIAL GAME ADVENTURE

Adventure for 4-6 Characters, Levels 1-4

Destiny of Kings

by Stephen Bourne

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Stop! If you plan to participate in this adventure as a player, please stop reading here. Knowing the details of the adventure will make it less fun to play for all concerned.

This adventure is designed for a party of four to six player characters (PCs) of the 1st to 4th levels of experience. A balance of character classes is needed since the PCs will face a wide variety of problems, each of which may be most easily and effectively solved by a character of a different class.

You, the Dungeon Master (DM), should read this entire adventure before playing. There are several plot elements that do not become fully developed until lace in the adventure, but the groundwork must be laid for them much earlier. If you are not already aware of these before play begins, you won't be able to plant clues or build drama as effectively, and the adventure will be less fun to play.

Study the maps while reading the area keys in this booklet. Most of these keys contain boxed information that should be read aloud to the players when their characters enter the area. Unboxed information is provided only as a guide for the DM; it is not read to the players. While every effort has been made to provide all information needed for play, you may want to add extra details to the boxed descriptions, purely to enhance the atmosphere.

The following abbreviations are used throughout this adventure:

AC	= Armour Class	MV	= Movement Rate
HD	= Hit Dice or Level	hp	= current hit points
#AT	= Number of Attacks	D	= Damage
AL	= Alignment	S	= Size of Monster
F	= Fighter	T	= Thief
MU	= Magic User	C	= Cleric
MK	= Monk	gp	= gold pieces
sp	= silver pieces	ep	= electrum pieces
cp	= copper pieces	pp	= platinum pieces

Non-player characters (NPCs) are introduced throughout the text where they are most likely to be encountered. When introduced, their statistics are shown in an abbreviated form with all combat and movement adjustments already figured in.

The Situation

The principal source of the evil besetting Dunador is Lord Edrin, brother to the deceased King Halfred and uncle to young Prince Edmund. All his life, Edrin has lived in the shadow of his older brother, nursing feelings of envy and spite toward the relation whose very existence barred him from access to the power he craved. A decade ago, with Halfred and most of his key advisors away at war, Edrin tried to seize the throne. The coup failed and the quaking younger sibling was forced to throw himself at Halfred's feet upon the sovereign's return. Despite his compassionate heart, the king was obliged to punish his scheming brother. Stripped of most of his titles and land, Edrin was sent south, there to reside in a modest castle as the minor lord of a small and poor principality.

Motivated both by his vaulting ambition and by a new bitterness at his brother's treatment of him, Edrin almost immediately renewed his plotting and slowly rebuilt his power base. A cornerstone of his strategy was to forge a secret alliance with Aimar, Duke of Andevar, a small, but important province on the northern border of Dunador.

Unwilling at first to throw his lot in with Edrin, Aimar's heart has changed in recent years due to Halfred's "injustice" toward him. Having twice lost parcels of land as a result of the king's rulings and having all too often seen his overly harsh judgments in civil matters overturned by the king's justice. Aimar has become increasingly estranged from his lord. The latest affront to Aimar's pride was an estate transfer just last spring favoring the king's old friend, William Menote, patriarch of Fontenmere. It was the loss of this rich tract of cropland that finally drove Aimar into Edrin's arms. Together, Lord Edrin and Duke Aimar have plotted for months, awaiting their chance.

A Death in Dunador

The plotter's chance finally came just a few days ago. While hunting in a rugged corner of the royal game preserve, Halfred was struck in the neck by an errant arrow and killed instantly. Some of those present wondered aloud whether, in fact. the shot was an accident, but there were witnesses in sufficient number to label it "misadventure."

While the witnesses quibbled. the clerics abored. But all for naught. Attempts to raise the king from the dead mysteriously failed. Only Lord Edrin and his assassin knew that the deadly projectile that felled Halfred was an unusual arrow of slaying whose effects would defy all remedy.

With the untimely death of King Halfred, the Dunador's political situation has rapidly deteriorated. The Royal Council, under the direction of Hollend, announced to the people that Prince Edmund will be king. Lord Edrin, however, has challenged the proclamation, putting forth his own claim to the throne. There are those at the court and elsewhere who support him. Only reverence for the old king and widespread esteem for Hollend have, for the moment, checked Edrin's plans.

After lengthy and tough negotiations, it has been agreed that Edmund will be king, but that Edrin will become regent during the period until Edmund can be located and plans for his coronation at Fontenmere Abbey can be finalized. In exchange for holding the throne for the young prince, Edrin has forced Hollend and the royal Council to accept him as next in line for the crown. In this dark and foreboding atmosphere, the great and near great of Dunador breathlessly await Edmund's return to Dunthrane.

All, that is, except Edrin. As regent, he has moved quickly. King Halfred's guards have been removed from Dunthrane. In their place Edrin has installed his own knights and has officially taken command of the military. Hollend and the Royal Council have no men-at-arms at their disposal at this rime.

Naturally, Hollend fears for Prince Edmund's safety. Wandering about in the wilds of northern Andevar, the young prince is a perfect target for assassination. Officially. Aimar (Duke of Andevar) has stayed neutral on the issue of succession, but Hollend suspects the worst. If only loyal warriors could be placed at Edmund's disposal! But the old cadre of loyal palace guards has been scattered to the winds under the command of officers loyal to Edrin. Without trustworthy military retainers at his disposal, the old king's advisor has been forced to consider a desperate plan.

Working in utmost secrecy, the aged Hollend has recruited a party of rugged adventurers to locate Edmund and bring him safely home. Bold and dangerous men have been brought in haste to southern Andevar, there to meet with Hollend to plan the most dangerous move in a dangerous game. Should this plot be revealed, none can expect to escape with their heads since the employment of a private mercenary force to locate and bring in Edmund can only be viewed as treasonous when the Royal Guard is already mounting its own official search. How easy it would be to lay at the feet of the plotters a purpose less wholesome than ensuring the safety of the young prince. How readily would Edrin leap at such a revelation in order to extend the duration of his regency on the pretext that the very foundations of the state were threatened by treason so close to the throne.

A Pilgrimage to Andevar

A few weeks before King Halfred's death, Prince Edmund embarked on a long pilgrimage to the holy shrine of Nevron in the Veronian Mountains For generations the princes of Dunador have made this holy trek on foot. Such a show of piety, humility, and devotion has always been thought most seemly in a man who would be king. Further, according to the sages, drinking from the sacred waters of Nevron would enhance an heir's wisdom and strength.

Thus, dressed in gray pilgrim's robes and accompanied by only a handful of lightly armed retainers, young Edmund set out on his pilgrimage at just that moment when his presence would be mostly sorely missed. By now he has been gone almost a month and his exact whereabouts are unknown. Lost in contemplation somewhere i
n the high mountains, it is doubtful that the young prince even knows of his father's fate or his people's need. Armed only with a true heart, a youthful piety, and a beggar's bowl, the prince is, in Hollend's considered judgment, extremely vulnerable.

Hollend has by no means underestimated his opponent's cunning or ruthlessness, either. Even as the king's advisor has moved to recruit his ream of mercenary rescuers, the Duke of Andevar's men have seized the prince in the Veronian Mountains. Lord Edrin has instructed Aimar to kill Edmund, but the duke is no fool. Hedging his bees, Aimar has taken Edmund to a secret stronghold just beyond the northern frontier of his realm.

Here, at Griffon Castle on the banks of the Laine River, young Edmund is held captive by order of the duke. As long as the power struggle continues, his fate is in the wind. If Edrin's bid to take the kingdom is completely successful, Aimar will surely kill Edmund. If Edrin fails, then the duke can release the prince and claim to be his savior. Nor has Aimar ruled out the possibility of simply selling the young prince to the highest bidder. For the moment, Aimar has reported to Edrin that he can't find Edmund.

Meanwhile, the evil regent has taken matters into his own hands. Unwilling to rely too heavily on his newly recruited henchman, he has sent a group of his own men-at-arms to Andevar to look for the prince, and, at the same time, loot Fontenmere Abbey. Disguised as brigands, Edrin's men have sacked Fontenmere by this time and made off with the royal seal and scepter of Dunador. Without these precious symbols, no coronation can take place. Ruthless and diabolical. Lord Edrin has left little to chance.

Ultimately, then, the group of adventurers must accomplish two things: secure the release of Prince Edmund and recover the artifacts required for the prince's coronation.

Synopsis

The following is a brief synopsis of these background events given in chronological order.

The Heir Apparent, Prince Edmund, embarks on a pilgrimage to the Shrine of Nevron in the Veronian Mountains of Andevar.

King Halfred of Dunador is slain in a hunting accident near the royal castle at Dunthrane.

Hollend, head of the Royal Council, announces that Prince Edmund will be crowned king upon returning from his pilgrimage.

Lord Edrin, brother to the late king and uncle to the prince, challenges Hollend's proclamation and puts forth his own claim to the throne.

The king's retainers, led by Hollend. strike a bargain whereby Edrin becomes regent until Edmund is crowned at Fontenmere Abbey.

Thereafter, Edrin will be next in line for the succession. In exchange for these concessions, Edrin agrees to recognize Edmund's claim to the throne.

Working in utmost secrecy and entirely without the knowledge of the Royal Council, Aimar, Duke of Andevar, seizes Prince Edmund and imprisons him at Griffon Castle.

Hollend seeks the aid of a party of adventurers to enter Andevar, find Prince Edmund, and return him safely to Dunthrane.

Lord Edrin's men, in the guise of brigands, sack Fontenmere Abbey, stealing the royal seal and scepter of Dunador.

The parry of mercenary adventurers retained by Hollend meets secretly with their employer at the Three Feathers Inn in the south of Andevar.

The adventure begins.

Names and Places

Aimar, Duke of Andevar: Secular authority in the northern province of Dunador. His men have seized Prince Edmund and now hold him at Griffon Castle.

Livery: A gold lion on a blue field. Aimar's elite citadel guards and close lieutenants wear a gold lion on a gray field instead.

Andevar: Northern province of Dunador and general location of this adventure.

Barbarian Bridge: Main crossing of the River Laine, located north of the Capel Tower.

Capel Tower: Northern outpost of Andevar, currently occupied by Lord Edrin's men.

Drake & Castle Inn: Roadside tavern at the foot of the Veronian Mountains.

Dunthrane: The capital of Dunador and the site of the royal court.

Dunador: The kingdom whose future is now at stake.

Edmund, Prince of Dunador: Heir to the throne and son of the late King Halfred. His deliverance is the main object of the quest.

Edrin, Regent of Dunador: Uncle to the prince and brother to the late king. He is the main villain in this piece.

Livery: A black raven on a dark gray field.

Fontenmere Abbey: Traditional coronation seat of the kings of Dunador. It is located in Andevar, to the west of Montinelle.

Griffon Castle: Secret fortification of the Duke of Andevar where Prince Edmund is held captive.

Halfred, King of Dunador: The departed sovereign whose untimely death precipitated the present crisis.

Livery: A light blue cross of Dunador on a canary yellow field.

Hollend: Chief advisor to the late king and head of the Royal Council. He is also Prince Edmund's main supporter. He has hired the party for this quest.

Kirkroy, Knight of Andevar: A henchman of the Duke of Andevar who will await the party at Barbarian Bridge.

Lusian Forest: A large wood in Andevar, rumored to be the site of some great evil. It is known to the local peasants as "the Darkwood."

Montinelle: The principal fortress of Andevar and home to Duke Aimar.

Shrine of Nevron: The holy shrine, located in the Veronian Mountains, which is the object of Prince Edmund's quest. Its magical waters are said to bestow wisdom and strength upon the true heir to the throne of Dunador.

Three Feathers Inn: The tavern where the party first meets Hollend.

Veronian Mountains: The high range marking the northwest frontier of Andevar.

William Menote: Patriarch of Fontenmere Abbey and senior cleric of Dunador. Menote is an old friend of the late king and a supporter of Prince Edmund.

A number of other, less important NPCs are mentioned in the text as they
are encountered.

Beginning the Adventure

As a first step in preparing for the adventure, pick one of the PCs to receive Hollend's message. Preferably, this should be a fighter, ranger, or fighter multi-class of good alignment. Someone of neutral alignment is also acceptable. Look mainly for leadership qualities in this adventurer. He will be responsible for "recruiting" the rest of the party for a dangerous mission.

In order to make the circumstances of the adventure more plausible, it will be necessary to establish some connection between Hollend and this individual that explains why Hollend would place such trust in him. If this adventure is being used as an isolated adventure, you can do this very easily simply by indicating that the chosen individual once served as a mercenary captain in Dunador and so is well known to Hollend.

If, on the other hand, you are fitting this adventure into an ongoing campaign, a less direct connection may be appropriate. In this case, make it the character's father who served Dunador. and indicate chat there is some "debt of honor"that the father once promised to pay by either coming to Hollend's aid at need or sending his kin to pay his debt. In this latter scenario, Hollend trusts the character because his father vouches for him. The son takes on the mission at the father's request.

When the leader has explained to the players how it is that he has been summoned co appear in Dunador, he informs them that on a certain day they must travel to the Three Feathers Inn, located in the Dunadorian province of Andevar. Aside from this information and whatever hints the leader may drop as to the reward that can be expected for serving the head of Dunador's Royal Council, the players will know nothing of their mission until briefed by Hollend. They will enter Andevar from the southwest (see map reference for "Start Here.")

Once the party is assembled and enters Andevar. read the following passage to them.

> It is with some apprehension that you enter the kingdom of Dunador. By now. rumors have traveled far and wide that things are not well in this troubled land. The king of Dunador has been killed, felled bv an arrow in what may have been a hunting accident, but might just as easily have been murder. Whatever the true late of King Halfred. it is now known far and wide that Dunador is a kingdom without a king. As you cross the frontier into this realm, it is clear that a great sadness is abroad. Everywhere the peasants have built mourning pyres and the air is thick with the heavy aroma of holy incense, certain signs of a sovereign's death.

The Three Feathers Inn is a safe haven for anyone in Prince Edmund's service. Rolfe, the innkeeper, once served in King Halfred's army and remains entirely loyal to the cause of Edmund and Hollend.

When the party arrives at the Three Feathers, Rolfe, who has been briefed by Hollend, recognizes its leader either from past acquaintance or from Hollend's description. If the party's leader is the son of one of Hollend's former comrades in arms, Rolfe (who also served with the father) identifies the son via some family resemblance. After identifying himself, the innkeeper leads the party to a back room where Hollend awaits them.

> At first, there is no sign of the king's chief advisor. Just an old itinerate tinker in the hooded, travel-stained cloak of his profession. But when the figure stands and throws back his hood, there is no mistaking him for any such thing. Tall, gaunt, and hatchet faced, Hollend wears authority like a suit of armor. Though quite aged now, the steel-gray beard still merges with a healthy head of curly hair and the sun-darkened skin exhibits a glow of health. Striding across the room, he grasps each ff your hands and welcomes you individually to Dunador. As he greets you, his icy blue eyes examine you as if appraising your worth.

Inviting the party to break their fast, Hollend directs them to a table laid with a simple meal of ale, bread, and cheese. While they eat, he contents himself with asking them about their trip and deftly prying from hem details about their backgrounds. Once he is satisfied that the party meets his requirements for skill, boldness, and trustworthiness, Hollend speaks more seriously..

> "Welcome, my friends, to this troubled land. Your arrival is timely indeed and thank you for your haste. By now, you have doubtless heard of the death of our king, Halfred of Dunthrane. For over 20 years I served him as chief advisor on the Royal Council. Through war and peace and feast and famine, I stood by this noble king until his death not a fortnight ago.
>
> "The story, as I say, is well-known. He was hunting near the royal castle at Dunthrane when a deadly arrow pierced his neck. Those in his party called it an accident and. by my troth, I can't say otherwise. But I have my suspicions, as do others. How does a yellow-clad man on a white horse look anything like a deer! How does any normal hunting arrow resist all attempts at curing its effects! We wonder much for little gain. Halfred is dead and we are plunged into sorrow.
>
> "But there is one in this realm who shed no tears at the fall of Halfred. Lord Edrin, the king's brother, has coveted the crown of Dunador for years. A decade gone by he made to seize it when my liege was gone to war, but he was stopped then while Halfred yet lived. This time, there may be no such grace for Dunador. With the king gone and our first tears of grief not yet dry upon our cheeks, he strode into the Royal Court with his black-clad knights to claim the throne. Only the sorrow of the people and the meager opposition of the Royal Council has thus far prevented him from taking the realm for his own. Already he has made himself regent of Dunador.
>
> "And thus we come co the purpose of our being here. There is one man --little more than a boy, really-- who can save us. Prince Edmund, Halfred's son and heir. should rightly wear the crown. And so he shall if he can but be spared the fate which I suspect his uncle of plotting for him.
>
> "For, you see, Edmund is lost now to the eyes of man. Just before his father's death, he set off on a pilgrimage to the Shrine of Nevron in the Veronian Mountains of our northern province of Andevar. For generations, the heirs apparent of Dunador have made this pilgrimage to the waters of Nevron. The sages say that drinking from the sacred waters give a prince the wisdom and strength to rule this realm when the rime comes. I know not of this, but such devotion does much to win the hearts of the people.
>
> "We pray that Prince Edmund will return soon from this pilgrimage, but we have reason to believe that he is not safe in Andevar. Aimar, the duke of this province, is a self-seeking man who might turn a blind eye to the prince's welfare if it served his purpose. Worse still, this Aimar may be in alliance with Lord Edrin. This is my worst fear, for if that be so, then my prince is in mortal danger in Andevar. Edrin has sworn to protect the Prince but to believe his word is to be less than a fool. Assassins may already be abroad in Andevar, with or without Duke Aimar's blessing.
>
> "Currently we do not know where Edmund is. Such is the nature of his pilgrimage. On foot with only a few men in pilgrim's garb. Edmund travels inconspicuously. By now he may have reached the Shrine of Nevron. We don't even if the prince has heard of his father's death. In an); event. he must be found and brought safely back to Dunthrane Castle. If Prince Edmund dies, the realm will be crushed

beneath the heel of this dark Lord Edrin.

"On behalf of the Royal Council, and in the utmost secrecy, I am asking you to enter Andevar and find Prince Edmund before it is too late. Anything you can learn of the Duke of Andevar's motives will also be of value to us, and we will pay well for such knowledge. But, it is the safety of the prince that is of greatest concern.

"I suggest you begin your search at Montinelle, the capital of Andevar and the home of Duke Aimar. Keep your eyes open and discover what you can of Aimar's disposition and the whereabouts of Prince Edmund. If this should prove profitless. the road through Montinelle will carry you directly to Nevron. where you ma); find the hunting better.

"But, whatever you do, remember this. At no time should you reveal the nature of your quest. If you are taken and your mission discovered, you will certainly die most horribly. and the Royal Council's position will
become extremely difficult. You will be wise to pass yourselves off as soldiers of fortune or, perhaps, as emissaries of a foreign country. Conceal your identities as you will.

"Also. mark well one other thing. In this whole region of Andevar, you can only trust two men: the patriarch of Fontenmere Abbey, William Menote, and Rolfe, the innkeeper here at the Three Feathers. If pressed, you may seek refuge there or here.

"If you succeed in this quest to find and save the prince, you will have the undying gratitude of this kingdom and the certain knowledge that you have saved it. More co the point, you will also be rewarded handsomely for your efforts. I beg you to accept this mission and I pray that you succeed in it."

After this speech, Hollend gives the parry 200 gp with which can buy provisions for the trip. He is also prepared to offer them fresh horses should they request them. Finally, he gives the parry's leader small portraits of Prince Edmund and William Menote, patriarch of Fontenmere, and a rough map of Andevar showing some (but not all) of the province's key features. This map (Map 1) does not show Eli's cottage, Griffon Castle, or the secret path through Noren's Wood.

In view of the long distances to be covered it is assumed that the PCs will use horses to journey through Andevar. Most of the time the horses will be walking with a movement base of 12 "(12 heres per day in clear areas; 5 heres per day in the Lusian Forest, Noren's Wood, the Veronian Mountains, and the Moorland). Galloping will at least double this movement base to 24" for short periods. Galloping over long distances, however, exhausts a mount
and you should keep track of such conditions. After a 20-mile gallop a horse will be almost ready to drop dead!

In the event that the party finds itself afoot, it will travel at the rate of four hexes per day in most of Andevar. Travel afoot through the Lusian Forest, Noren's Wood, or the Veronian Mountains is at the rate of two hexes per day.

Road Encounters Table

Roll 1d6

1 20 Brigands (AC 6, MV 24"; hp 5 each; F1; #AT 1; D 1-8; AL E) with one leader (AC 6; MV 24 "; hp 20; F3; #AT 1; D 1-8; AL E). Each brigand is mounted on a light horse (AC 7; HD 2; hp 12 each; MV 24"; #AT O; S L; AL N). Each brigand carries 1-20 sp, 1-10 gp, and a sword. The leader carries 50 gp and a sword.

2 15 Bandits (AC:; MV 24"; hp 5 each; D 1-6, AL E). Each bandit is mounted on a light horse (AC 7; MV 24"; HD 2; hp 12 each; #AT O; S L; AL N). Each bandit is armed with a lance and short sword, and each carries 1-20 sp and 1-10 gp.

3 10 Berserkers (AC 7; MV 12"; hp 6 each; F1; #AT 2; D 1-8; AL N). Each berserker carries 1-20 sp, a sword, and an axe.

4 A merchant caravan that has been sacked by its guards. Only six survivors can be found: four men and two women. They have no possessions other than the clothes on their backs but, if escorted to Montinelle, they generously reward anyone who assisted them.

5 10 Goblins (AC 6; MV 6"; hp 6 each; HD 1; #AT 1; D 1-6; AL E). Each goblin carries a club and 1-20 sp.

6 3 Jackalweres(AC 4; MV 12"; hp 20 each; HD 4; #AT 1; D 2-8; AL E). The members of this hunting pack at first appear disguised as pilgrims and claim to be either on their way to the Shrine of Nevron (if the party is headed in that direction) or on their way home from the shrine (if the party is headed away from Nevron). The jackalweres cry to join the party "for protection." If permitted to do so, they work into position for a surprise attack at close quarters. If denied this opportunity, they attack immediately.

The Road Encounters Table indicates the wandering monsters that are found on the open roads of Andevar. For every 40 miles of open road traveled, check once for an encounter which occurs on a roll of 1 on 1d6. Use the Road Encounters Table when the party is traveling along any roads except the path through Lusian Forest or the track leading to the Shrine of Nevron.

If the party insists on plunging into the surrounding wilderness, then refer to the Off-Road Encounter Table to determine what encounters they have. The Off-Road Encounters Table is used only for cross-country travel in areas other than the Lusian Forest. Cross-country movement is impossible in the rugged Veronian Mountains. For every 20 miles of wilderness traveled. check once for an encounter which will occur on a roll of 1 or 2 on 1d6.

Off-Road Encounters Table

Roll 1d6

1 25 Brigands (AC 6, MV 24"; hp 6 each; F1, #AT 1; D 1-8; AL E) with one leader (AC 6; MV 24"; hp 22; F3; #hT 1; D 1-8; AL E). Each brigand is mounted on a light horse (AC 7; MV 24"; HD 2; hp 12 each; #AT 0; S L; AL N). Each bandit is armed with a sword and carries 3-30 gp. The leader carries 60 gp.

2 20 Gnolls (AC 5; MV')"; hp 10 each; HD 2; #AT 1; D 2-8; AL E) with one leader (AC 5; MV 9"; hp 16; HD 3; #AT 1; D 2-8; AL E). Each gnoll is armed with a sword and carries 2-12 ep. In addition, five of the gnolls carry great bows and the rest carry polearms. The leader is armed with a sword and carries 8 gp. The gnolls are accompanied by six hyenas (AC 7; MV 12"; hp 10 each; HD 3: #AT 1; D 2-8; AL N).

3 15 Wild Dogs (AC:: MV 15": hp:. HD 1 +1; #AT 1; D 1-4; AL N).

4 20 Hobgoblins (AC 5; MV 9"; hp 7 each; HD 1 + 1; #AT 1; D 1-8; AL E) of the Ripper tribe. Each hobgoblin carries a sword and 2-8 gp.

5 2 Perytons (AC 7; MV 24 "; hp 22. 20; HD 4; #AT 1 (+ 2 to hit), D 4-16, AL E). These winged carnivores are extremely hungry, having hunted for some time without success. They can be harmed only by magical weapons.

6 9 Wolves (AC 7; HD 2+2; hp 14 each; #AT 1; D 2-5; S S; AL N).

Montinelle is the stronghold of the Duke of Andevar. It consists of an octagonal area approximately 270 feet from side to side enclosed by a 40-foot-high stone curtain wall. The wall is broken at each corner by a guard tower. Each of the eight towers (T1-T8) about the castle has a ground-level chamber with a spiral staircase leading 60 feet up to a trap door and the open parapets above. Each of the lower chambers is a combination armory and guardhouse containing locked weapons racks holding spears, lances, maces, crossbows, and bolts), oil barrels, two small beds, and a stove and pantry area for catering. At any time, one guard will be off duty in the lower guardhouse and one will be above on the parapets. All the guards are human.

The Tower Guard Roster lists all tower guards. Each wears a blue tunic with the gold lion insignia of the Duke of Andevar.

The two gatehouses flanking the southern entrance each contain a lower chamber used as a guardroom. There are no armories in these guardrooms. Spiral stairs lead from the lower chambers to the parapets above. Each guardroom contains a pair of small beds, a fireplace equipped with iron pothooks, and a cabinet housing heavy crockery, pots, and cooking utensils. The western gatehouse also contains a rude table and chair and a rough shelf full of dusty ledgers along the north wall. It serves as an office to the sergeant-at-arms who keeps a sketchy record of the comings and goings through the southern gate. If questioned, the guards atop the eight wall towers direct all travelers to the office of the sergeant-at-arms.

Leaving Montinelle

Upon approaching the southern gate, the party is stopped by two castle guards armed with swords (AC 6; MV 12 "; F3, hp 22; #AT 1; D 1-8; AL N). Over their chainmail they wear blue tunics with the gold lion of the Duke of Aimar on the breast. The guards immediately call the sergeant-at-arms (AC 6; MV 12"; F4; hp 34, #AT 1; D 1-8; AL N) who also wears the Andevar livery over his chainmail. He subjects the characters to routine questioning as to their business inside Montinelle. If satisfied that they have a legitimate errand inside the castle and aren't going to cause trouble, he orders the group to enter his office and sign the register book on the table that serves as his desk. If the characters offer a bribe of 2 gp or more, the sergeant-at-arms lets them look at the register. It shows that "Edmund of Dunthrane" entered Montinelle 10 days previous, leaving the castle on the following morning. Immediately below the entry showing Edmund's departure is the name "Kirkroy," a reference to an individual who apparently left Montinelle shortly after the prince. In truth, Kirkroy is the agent who followed the prince and abducted him..

The interior of Montinelle is divided into seven areas:

A. The Market
B. Peasant Huts
C. The Jousting Field
D. The Reviewing Stand
E. Stables
F. Barracks
G. The Citadel

Entry to areas C through G is restricted. Any attempt to force an entry during daylight arouses the castle guards patrolling the market, guarding the stable and main gate, and relaxing in the barracks. As soon as a disturbance is noted, the gate is closed. Sustained disturbances attract a company of 20 guards from the citadel. In addition, in the event of a general melee, 4-16 guards from the wall towers also appear.

Arrest and Imprisonment

Obviously, investigations conducted inside Montinelle must be performed with a certain discretion. Open melee or unsophisticated questioning that draws attention to the party will lead to the characters' arrest. Points of special danger occur when the party is in the market trying to locate a source of information; if and when the party attempts to bribe the sergeant-at-arms in order to get a look at his records; if and when the party tries to gin entrance to the citadel. In any of these three instances, suspicions will be aroused unless a plausible cover story is presented that adequately explains why information is being sought.

Should the suspicions of individuals who are not guardsmen be aroused, they report the matter to the guard. Should isolated guardsmen become suspicious, they let the group go about its business until they can quietly summon overwhelming force to the vicinity. Once a superior force of guardsmen arrives or a melee breaks out, the guard tries to arrest the characters. Beggars, merchants, servants, and peasants do not become involved in the affair, but there are 47 fighters in the castle who do: Sir Bracken, 16 tower guards. 20 castle guards, the sergeant-at-arms, and 10 citadel guards.

The characteristics of the tower guards have already been described. Except where otherwise noted, castle guards are (AC6. MV 12"; F3; hp 24; #AT 1; D 1-8, AL N). All citadel guards are (AC 3; MV 9"; F6; hp 40; #AT 1 or 2; D 1-8 with sword, 1-6 with bow; AL LE). Each guard (of any type) carries 2-20 gp. Citadel guards wear over their plate armor gray tunics with gold lions to indicate their special status. The rest of the guards are, unless otherwise noted, equipped only with chainmail and wear the blue and gold livery of Andevar.

Sir Bracken is (AC 2; MV 3"; FG, hp 44; #AT 1; D 2-8; AL LE). In addition to his sword +1, he carries a special net of entrapment with one remaining charge. In melee, he uses this device to incapacitate anyone within a 10-foot radius of the target area. The net, when cast, acts so quickly that escape from its grasp is highly unlikely. Each player is entitled to a saving throw on 1d20. but an unmodified roll of 20 is needed to evade the net. Those who fail to save are disarmed and totally incapacitated, unable even to cast a spell. Sir Bracken will use the net when it will have the maximum effect, inside or outside the citadel.

Throughout any melee, it is the intent of Sir Bracken and his men to capture the party by any means. While willing to injure and incapacitate, they are reluctant to kill and repeatedly call on the party to surrender.

If arrested or subdued, the members of the party are disarmed, stripped of their armor and tunics and taken to cell D4 of the dungeon. All of their gear is stashed in or next to the large chest in the jailor's office (D1). Sir Bracken accuses the characters of being spies and threatens them with individual interrogation at a later time, but they will never actually be harmed. If the characters ask to see the duke, they are informed that Aimar is not currently in residence at the castle. Should Sir Bracken use the net of entrapment to aid in the capture of the group, he comments to the members of the parry on how upset he is at having had to use up the last of the net's power and how he intends to make them regret causing him to do so.

Tower Guard Roster

Location	Class/Level	AL	Weapons	Combat Bonus	Armor	AC	hp
T1	F2	LN	sword, bow	+1 with bow	chain	7	14
	F3	LN	sword, bow		chain	6	21
T2	F4	LN	sword, crossbow		plate	4	26
	F3	LN	sword, bow	+1 with bow	chain	6	22
T3	F4	LN	sword, bow		splint	7	34
	F3	LN	sword, crossbow	+1 with X-bow	chain	7	27
T4	F5	LN	sword, bow	+1 with bow	banded	6	37
	F3	LN	sword, spear		chain	6	26

A. The Market

The entire southern portion of the castle grounds is an open market area studded with gaily colored tents, canopied merchant stalls and small enclosures housing numerous varieties of common livestock. The vendors at this market fair have available for purchase at normal prices all of the items listed on page 36 of the Player's Handbook other than weapons and armor. Fine clothes, silks, linens, and sundry art objects may also be found, but at slightly inflated prices (normal price plus 10 to 20 percent).

The market areas is thronged with peasants, merchants. and the ever-present beggars. Ominously, there seem to be members of the castle guard everywhere, filing between the stalls in ones and twos, their eyes open for trouble. You should point out to the players at some time during their passage through this area that at least one pair of guards is eyeing them with suspicion.

If the players attempt to obtain information at the market fair, they draw a blank from the ignorant peasants. Even market regulars know little. However. any merchant or beggar approached by the party will eventually, in exchange for a few gold pieces, direct them to a certain Lemus, a peasant living in the cottage marked with an "*" in area B2 of the Montinelle map. Beyond this, no one in Montinelle seems to know anything except his own business.

B. The Peasant Huts

The peasants who work the land surrounding the castle are housed in this cluster of squalid, mud-daubed, wattle-and-thatch huts. Apart from Lemus and the odd porcine house pet, there is virtually nothing of interest in this area. If the players insist on making a detailed examination, treat them to a tour of almost identical, dirt-floored dwellings containing only straw pallettes, crude cooking facilities, wall pegs for clothing, a roughly carpentered table and chairs, and perhaps a plank fixed to one wall as a pantry. Between the hours of 6 a.m. and 6 p.m. only the very old and the very young will be found in this area. All able-bodied men and women are at work in the fields or the market.

The cottage marked "*" is, as noted, the home of Lemus, an ancient, crippled beggar who was once a warrior in the king's service. Despite the wretchedness of his current condition, Lemus remains a loyal king's man. Moreover, Lemus has recently spoken with one of the prince's companions and has reason to be suspicious of strangers inquiring concerning Edmund.

Unless he is satisfied that the members of the party are friendly to the king. Lemus provides them with no information. At first, he questions them closely. Once he is certain that they are no threat to the king's interests, he becomes willing to answer questions concerning Edmund, providing that first his tongue is loosened by a few pieces of silver or a skin of wine. He then provides the following entertainment in a voice cracked with age:

> "Twas more'n week gone by now. I seen the young prince an' his companions. Ha! Dressed as pilgrims, they was. But pilgrims don't wear shiny gold on they fingers nor has bright neck braces winkin' under they gray pilgrims' cloaks. Knew 'em right off. I did. Knew 'em an' spoke to one. Nay the prince, but another. We spoke a bit, spoke o' the old days, o' Dunador an' the king. Oh,'twas grand, all right. Grand. He give me gold afore he left. A proper gentleman, he was.
>
> "I pray they did well. But that be somethin' I ain't too sure 'bout. They was nervous like, an' I heard one atellin' young Edmund as 'ow they was still bein' followed an' 'ad better get on to Nevron an' see to they business. That seemed t' set em to movin'. an' they slipped out the next day, quiet like. Headin' for Nevron an' them cursed mountains, I 'spect."

Though this is all that Lemus knows of the prince's party, he does have one more bit of news which he provides if plied with more money or wine:

> "Well, aye. there be one more thing tha may be o' interest, seein' as 'ow you be eager t' learn.'Twas day afore yesterday, I guess. A monk come in wearin' the habit o' Fontenmere. Straight to the tower there e rode, an' ain't no one seen 'im since. No, nor heard what happened to bring 'im 'ere. Which is real strange, ya see, cause it ain't that often that folks ride in on horses all lathered an' with a arrow stickin' outa they monkish backs. Yep, well. If I was a curious man, which I ain't, I'd sure be wonderin' what 'appened t' that monk and why ain't nobody can get nothin' about 'im outta them guards up t' the citadel. Yeah. I sure would wonder."

Having imparted these two valuable bits of information, Lemus declines to provide further useful knowledge, answering all additional queries by returning to how he "jes' couldn't 'elp wond'rin' 'bout that monk."

C. The Jousting Field

The 40-foot by 130-foot open area near the west wall is Duke Aimar's jousting field. It is divided into lists by three low, open fences running its length. In the absence of the duke, there is no activity in this area.

D. The Reviewing Stand

The reviewing stand is a 5-foot-high open platform of raw, weathered lumber topped by an open wooden framework used to support a canopy during tournaments. Since no tournaments are planned in the near future, the canopy over the reviewing stand, the skirts that normally hide its supports, and the chairs that normally occupy the platform have all been stowed under the stand.

E. The Stable

The long, low stone stable houses 30 light horses, together with all manner of riding gear. At the back of each stall is a generously filled oat bin. A castle guard stands at each entrance, and a stable boy is busy tending to the livestock.

F. The Barracks

The solid structure at F is a sturdy stone barracks built directly into the curtain wall surrounding Montinelle. At any given time there will be 3-10 guards wiling away their off-duty hours inside the structure. Without their armor, the guards are (AC 10; MV 9"; F3; hp 20: #AT 1; D 1-8; AL LN). If roused, it rakes them two rounds to get their swords; they never waste time donning their armor.

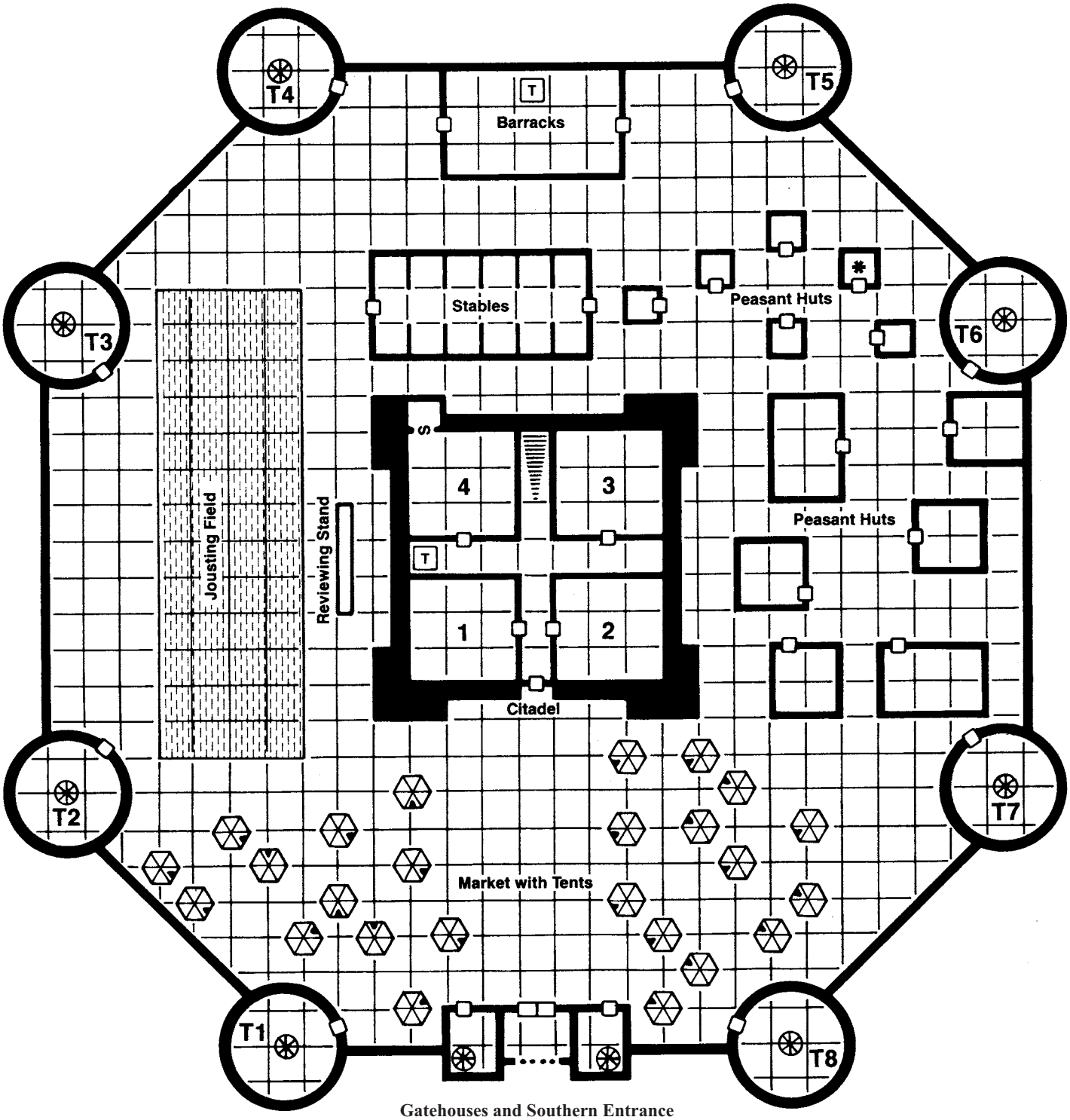
The interior of the barracks is a single low room. Ten rickety cots line each of the long walls. Suspended from the foot of each cot is an equipment pack. There is a small fireplace equipped for cooking in the center of the south wall. It is flanked by wooden plank shelves groaning under the weight of various cooking implements and provender bins. Bags of spices hag from the nearby rafters. Opposite this fireplace is a long trestle table and a pair of benches. Beneath this table, obscured by a shaggy rug fashioned from the skin of some obscure animal, is a trap door leading to a secret underground passage that connects these barracks with the dungeon below the citadel.

In addition to the miscellaneous equipment in the equipment packs hanging from the foot of each bed, a complete ransacking of the barracks will turn up 5-100 gp and 100 600 sp in coins.

G. The Citadel

Dominating Montinelle is Duke Aimar's citadel. Its single, unhidden entrance in the south wall is guarded by a pair of tough-looking citadel guards in the gray and gold of the Duke of Andevar. Any attempt to enter this way, whether by negotiation or force. results in Sir Bracken's arrival. Any further attempt at entry, whether by force or as a

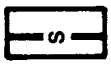
Map 3: Montinelle (ground level)



Gatehouses and Southern Entrance

1 square = 10 feet

Note: walls are 40 feet high, towers are 60 feet high.



Secret Door

Spiral Stairs

Trap Door (in floor)

Stairs

result of an invitation, results in Sir Bracken casting his net of entrapment over the group in an attempt to arrest them. If a confrontation occurs outside the entrance, Sir Bracken casts the net from the shadows just inside the gateway. Otherwise, he waits until the group is already inside the citadel to spring his little surprise on them.

Citadel Main Level

A cruciform hallway divides the main level of the citadel into four chambers. When opened, the trap door in the west arm of the hall of this level reveals a flight of spiral stairs leading down to the jailor's office (D1) below. The staircase in the north arm of the hall leads directly to an open landing on the upper level.

1. Sir Bracken's Room

> The entire northwest corner of this chamber is dominated by a mahogany four-poster with drawn gray velvet curtains. A large one drawer ironwood desk is located beside it. Against the south wall is a bulky cabinet, flanked by a pair of heavy, iron-bound oaken chests. Every square inch of the available wall space seems to be occupied by weaponry or shields. Some are in pristine condition. Others, obviously battle trophies, are twisted and dented to the point of uselessness. A few of the less serviceable items are graced with crusty brown stains.

The locked drawer of the desk contains a ring of keys and a diary. The keys unlock all of the citadel's doors except for those giving access to the wine cellar and to the duke's rooms. The diary is Sir Bracken's personal chronicle of the mundane events characterizing garrison life for many months in the past. The last entry, several days old, consists only of the name "Kirkroy" on a page by itself.

Both of the chests against the south wall are securely locked. That to the left of the cabinet contains 100 gp worth of silks and fine linens. Beneath these is a small locked chest containing 300 gp and 400 sp. The chest to the right of the cabinet contains an unpainted shield, a jewel-inlaid short sword worth 200 gp. a broadsword and two long swords, all extremely well-made.

The tall cabinet contains two dozen skins and a score of fine tunics befitting a knight of high station. At the rear of the cabinet hangs a suit of chain mail of a type commonly used in jousting. A large footlocker built into the cabinet holds a small saddle inlaid in silver (600 sp).

Located in the bedpost nearest the desk is a secret compartment about four feet from the floor. By sliding back a cunningly hidden panel in the post, the characters gain access to this recess where they find a 10-inch hollow tube of mithril. This is a chime of opening with 10 charges. If pointed at a lock of any kind, including a held portal or wizard-locked door, striking the chime opens the lock or portal. However, each use of the chime causes it to emit a loud, resonating tone which attracts anyone or anything in the vicinity. Each striking of the chime uses one charge and unlocks one lock. Thus, a door, lid, or portal locked by more than one means would require more than one striking of the chime in order to open it. For example, it would take four charges to open a locked, chained, wizard-locked, and padlocked chest. Striking the chime within 10 feet of a concealed door automatically opens that door regardless of whether the user knows that the door is present.

2. Barracks of the Citadel Guard

> The north and south walls of this chamber are each lined with five sturdy oak beds strewn with warm furs. To the left of each bed is a tall oak wall cabinet.

All of the cabinets are locked. Inside, each is divided horizontally into a pair of compartments. The left compartment contains one or more shirts of varying quality, a pair of gray guardsman's tunics, several pairs of matching hose, a guardsman's dress bonnet and a pair of parade shoes. A shelf at the top of this compartment contains small items of personal gear: toiletries, razors, dice, and the like. Racked against the walls of the right compartment of each cabinet is an assortment of normal weapons, including a bow with a quiver of arrows, two or three spears, and two cased shields in the colors of Andevar. Also hanging loose in this compartment is a collection of leatherwork. Some is dyed a bright yellow and is clearly part of the guardsman's dress harness. The rest consists of plain brown or black belts, bracers, caps, and other (mostly non-regulation) items. The cabinet directly to the south of the door contains a spear +1 and a small sack stuffed with 300 sp.

3. Kitchen and Pantry

> What could this be but a kitchen! Almost the whole of the north wall is taken up by a combination iron stove and oven. The rest of the walls are occupied from floor to ceiling with a massive shelving arrangement, containing an orderly array of post, pans, bowls, crocks, bags, boxes, and tins. Bunches of hard sausages and cheeses, drying herbs, and vegetables adorn every rafter. The floor space is occupied by a jumble of tables and carts holding butcher blocks and breadboards. An aged, bald, stoop-shouldered little serving man In a greasy white smock stands at one of these. mindlessly fussing with a batch of bread dough.

The fellow occupied with making the day's bread is one Matlocke (AC 10; MV 6"; T3. hp 12; #AT 0; AL NE). This greasy little man, the Duke's cook, is noted among his peers for both his cowardliness and his aversion to the truth. Formerly a member of the guard, Matlocke is now far too old to fight, a profession for which he never had much taste anyway. Long since retired to the kitchen service, he has prospered in a mean way by tyrannizing lesser servants and picking the pockets of the guards whenever he thinks he can get away with it.

Suspended from a leather thong around Matlocke's neck is a small dagger and a pouch containing 10 sp. Otherwise. he has no possessions of note.

If left unattended by the members of the party. Matlocke summons the citadel guard at the earliest opportunity If an unwary party member approaches too closely, he has a 30% chance of losing something from his pecker to Matlocke's nimble fingers. If the characters bribe or threaten him, Matlocke will, in answer to the proper questions, reveal the entire sum of his knowledge, including the following:

> "Och. aye! The prince an' them others left Montinelle jus' this past ten-day. I guess we weren't supposed to know who they was, but it was plain as the nose on yer face, if ya' take my meaning."
>
> "Nay, 'is lordship, the duke, ain't in the castle. What's more,'e 'asn't been home fer a week. Gone north, they say."
>
> "Kirkroy! Aye, sure. Everybody knows Kirkroy. Why.'e's the duke's strong right arm! Chief hiresword an' champion-at-arms. that's Kirkroy. But 'e ain't in the castle now. Naw. 'e left right after the prince did."
>
> "Och, well now. Let's see. 'Twas maybe a week ago that we got news o' the king's death. That was then the duke rode out leavin' orders fer a patrol to go after the prince and tell 'im about 'is father's death. Caught up with 'im by now. I 'spect."

4. Storage Chamber

The door to this chamber is locked.

> Clearly a larder of some sort, this chamber is panelled in some dark, rough insulating wood. The west wall is lined with deep shelves on which are stacked dozens of large. bulging gunny sacks. Along the east wall are half a dozen casks. There are four great north upright barrels against the north wall.

The barrels hold drinking water; the sacks contain grain and flour; the casks hold oil of varying quality.

Behind the barrel in the northwest corner of the chamber is a secret door. If the players push outward on the wall panel behind this barrel, the panel slides back to reveal a concealed room beyond. Stacked to the ceiling of this room are dozens of small oak casks of fine brandy, mead, and ale. On a table against the north wall is a small leather-bound box. Inside is a vial of clear liquid --a potion of sweet water.

Citadel Upper Level

From the landing on the upper level, an adjacent staircase leads to a trap door high in the ceiling. Above this trap door are open-air parapets which are constantly patrolled by 1-4 of the citadel guards.

5. Bathing and Privy Chamber

> The eastern portion of this bathing chamber is occupied by a shallow, marble-inlaid pool. A garderobe, its door now hanging ajar, is built into the northwest corner.

6. Study and Meeting Chamber

> From the richly veined rose marble of the fireplace in the northeast corner to the velvet smoothness of the dark walnut paneling, this room exudes an aura of wealth. The floor is covered by what is obviously a costly and very antique carpet of indeterminate hue. Three wine-colored upholstered armchairs are clustered around the fireplace. Against the north wall is a small bookcase of some dark wood enclosed by a pair of leaded glass doors. Against the west wall is a carved walnut desk with a beautiful matching high-backed chair. Half-a-dozen shadowed portraits bearing the accumulated grime of centuries stare down on the opulence.

This chamber is Aimar's study.

The single locked drawer in the desk contains the duke's estate ledger. A quick look is sufficient to indicate that Andevar is far more prosperous than it looks. A closer examination reveals much concerning the duke's affairs, including the information that a substantial parcel of land north of Fontenmere Abbey and its proceeds were transferred from ducal authority to the control of William Menote, Patriarch of Fontenmere. This entry notes that the transfer, ordered by King Halfred in order to "provide for the maintenance of the abbey at Fontenmere," has been accomplished entirely "against the will of and under strong protest by the Duke of Andevar."

Also stored in the desk drawer is a solid gold paperweight in the shape of a lion worth 200 gp. Finally, in the very back of the drawer, is an apparently long-forgotten scroll. This is a cursed magic-user's scroll: any magic-user who reads it and fails to save vs. spells suffers a devastating, psionic-like mental attack. Losing both mind and personality, the victim is reduced to a vegetable state (a la *feeblemind*) with an Intelligence of 1. Speech and rational behavior are no longer possible; only basic motor functions remain. A successful *alter reality* or *remove curse* spell can restore the victim to normal functioning.

If the drawer is removed completely, a keen-eyed character notices a slim cord in the back of the drawer cavity. Pulling this cord draws forth a small secondary drawer from the back of the desk. Within is a magic-user's scroll of *ESP*.

The bookcase contains four score handwritten books, many on the history of Dunador. A thorough examination of titles turns up one on the role of religion and the state in Dunadorian society written by William Menote, Patriarch of Fontenmere, and dedicated to "Good King Halfred."

7. The Great Hall

> The most prominent feature of this large, finely appointed chamber is a long, carved oak trestle table lined with sumptuous high-backed, carved oak chairs upholstered in wine-red leather. Running the length of the south wall is a caved limestone fireplace. Above the mantle hangs a gold lion coat-of-arms. The other walls are clothed in fine antique tapestries whose slightly frayed appearance only confirms their great age and enhances their worth. Three large, gold candelabra rest atop the table. There is a glass-doored oak cabinet in the northeast corner.

The candelabra are worth 200 gp each. The cabinet contains a silver service with a total value of 1.000 gp. The gold lion coat-of-arms, set into a wooden plaque, is worth 500 gp. It can be pried out of its mounting for easier carriage.

8. Servants' Quarters

> The plainness of this chamber and its furnishings is in sharp contrast to the elaborately carved door in the south wall. Against this masterpeice of the woodworker's art, the mismatched pair of beds, the two dented dressers and the duo of shabby night stands that make up the room's contents seem strangely out of place. Only the glossy animal skin rug in the center of the floor looks like it really belongs here.

These are the quarters of the duke's body servants. The door in the south wall leads to the duke's bedchamber. It is securely bolted from room 9,has 50 hp, and can only be opened from room 8 if a *knock* spell is used or if the door is smashed to pieces. The *chime of opening* will not work against this simple bolt.

Each nightstand contains a locked drawer. One drawer contains a sack of 50 ep, the other a sack of 20 gp. The rug is the pelt of a giant beaver. A ranger or a character with furrier/trapper secondary skill recognizes its worth: 1,000 gp.

9. The Duke's Chamber

The door to the duke's chamber is locked and wizard-locked. It can be opened by expending two charges from the chime of opening. In addition, a magic-user of the 6th level or better can automatically open the door once the normal lock is dealt with. Lesser magic-users must cast a *knock* spell in order to do so. The door (which has 50 hp) can also be broken down with an axe.

> A large, ornately carved four-poster occupies the southeast corner of the chamber. Its bottle-green curtains are tied back to show that it is empty. Centered in the north and west walls are a pair of doors That in the north wall is flanked on one side by a five-drawer dresser and on the other by a tall cabinet whose double doors are inlaid in gold foil with the ducal coat of arms. A small chest sits atop a table in the southwest corner. The walls are decorated with fine tapestries.

Once inside the room, the party is attacked by an invisible stalker (AC 3; MV 12 "; HD 8; hp 50; #AT 1; D 4-16; AL N). The creature is invisible (-4 to hit). 30% resistant to magic. and is solely devoted to the purpose of defending Aimar's chamber. In melee, the characters suffer a -4 penalty to hit unless they can see invisible objects and creatures. The invisible stalker fights to the death.

The cabinet is locked. Within are two score fine tunics, a score of pantaloons and dozens of shirts and pairs of stockings. Hanging in a separate compartment from the clothing is a suit of *chain mail +2* in perfect condition and suitable for a large elf, half elf, or human. Also in this compartment is a *battle axe +l* and a *broadsword +1*.

The top drawer of the dresser contains a

jumble of jars and bottles filled with sundry salves and powders. Most are perfectly mundane, but a large jar marked "K. S." contains five applications of *Keoghtom's Ointment*.

The locked chest holds 1,500 gp and 500 sp, in addition to the duke's neck brace of office worth 200 gp.

Below the table containing the chest is a loose flagstone covering a hidden recess in the floor. Here lies Aimar's spellbook, containing the following: *magic missile*, *shocking grasp*, *charm person*, *jump*, *read magic*, *wizard lock*, *ray of enfeeblement*, and *fireball*. Beside the spellbook is a small leather pouch containing a vial of liquid. This is a specially magicked *antidote* to the cursed magic-user's scroll from room 6. Consuming all of this liquid restores the victim's faculties. It does not remit maladies stemming from any cause other than this scroll.

Citadel Dungeon Level

The downward spiral stairs on the ground level lead directly to room D1 of the dungeon.

D1. Jailor's Office

> A guttering torch stuck in a bracket set into the east wall provides little light and less warmth to this dank chamber of morticed stone. A filthy cot against the north wall is occupied by a dark-clad sleeping figure in grimy leather breeches and vest. Beside the bed is a big, iron-bound oak chest.

The sleeping figure is Ranu, the jailor (AC 7; MV 6"; F4; hp 26; #AT 1; D 1-6; AL LN). Nestled on the bed next to him (and obscured by his body) is a heavy club. A set of keys to all of the dungeon's cells hangs from his belt.

The chest contains a motley collection of rusty, old weapons and bits of decaying armor. If any player characters have been captured, their weapons and armor ate also inside. Beneath the chest, under a loose flagstone, is Ranu's treasure trove of 50 gp, 800 sp, 3,000 cp, and a large amount of cheap jewelry worth 100 gp.

D2. Wine Cellar

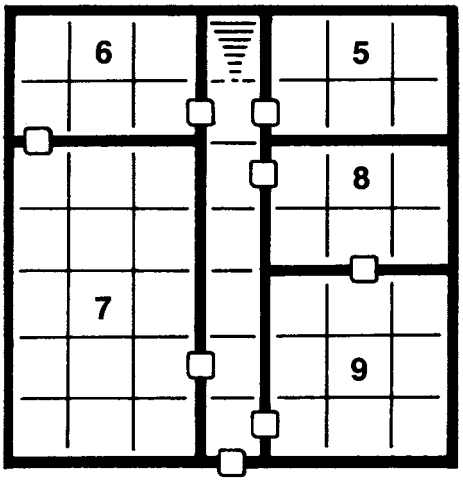
The door to this room is locked. Sir Bracken carries the key on a chain around his neck.

> Clearly, the duke keeps his wine cellar well stocked. Row upon row of dusty bottles glitter in half a dozen ceiling-high racks set perpendicular to the north wall. Against the south wall, on either side of the door, are a dozen small casks resting in multi-tiered cradles.

All of this wine, which is the product of local vineyards, is quite excellent.

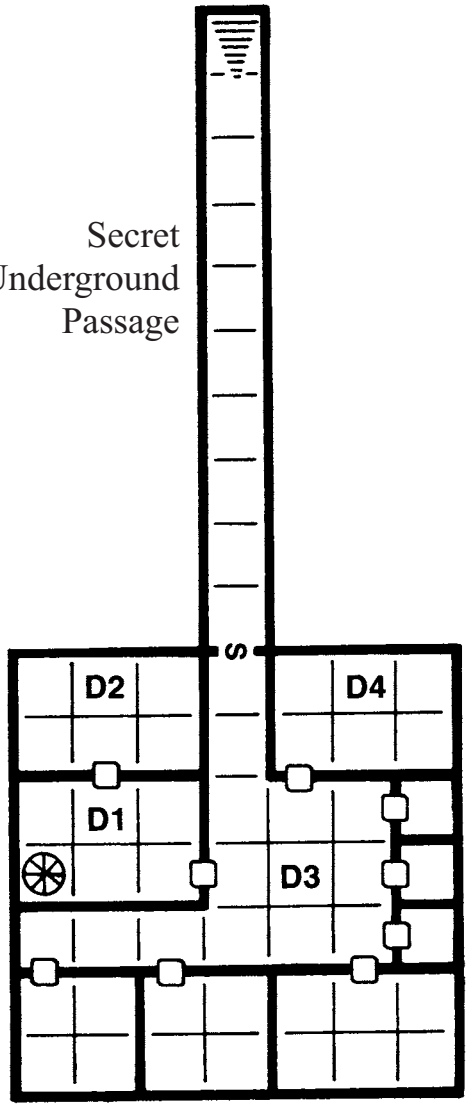
Map 4: Montinelle (citadel)

Level II (upper level)



Note: above level II are open-air parapets.

Secret Underground Passage



Dungeon (lower level)

D3. Torture Chamber

> If the chains and manacles suspended from the main ceiling beams didn't indicate this chamber's purpose, the great rack and wheel in its center would do so. Clearly the duke takes the task of interrogation seriously. Suspended from hooks lining the west wall are a variety of tongs, pincers, nd other grisly looking tools, none of which seem like they could possibly have any wholesome purpose. Next to the door in the west wall is a large, deep brazier equipped with a sort of bellows. Set into the north, east, and south walls of the chamber are seven sturdy doors, each of which is equipped with a covered peephole.

The seven doors lead to individual cells. Each 4 x 4 inch wooden peephole cover is closed with a simple dead bolt. Sliding back the bolt allows the cover to swing back so that the cell within can be examined without having to actually open the door. The cell doors are locked from the outside with both key locks and heavy dead bolts.

There is a secret door in the north wall of the chamber. Pulling a loose stone in that wall causes a counter-weighted segment of the wall to slide back revealing the secret passage leading to the barracks outside the citadel. A similar arrangement on the other side of the wall can be used to open and close the secret door from the passageway. Behind the loose stone on the dungeon side of the wall is a locking ring. If twisted to the right, it closes a bolt. preventing anyone from opening the secret door from the passageway.

D4. Jail Cell

> This grimy, mean little room appears to be partly constructed of limestone blocks and partially cut from the living bedrock below Montinelle. Moisture oozes from the rock and soaks the decaying straw strewn over its rough flags. In several places the damp straw has been piled high to make a kind of nest for sleeping. The air is thick with the miasma left by the countless poor wretches who have been forced to accept its hospitality in the past.

If captured, the party is confined together in this large cell. Under a pile of straw in the northwest corner, the characters can find a loose flag. With much effort, it can be pried loose. Underneath, they find a blunted dagger, a rusty file, and a piece of a broken shield. By making use of the dagger and shield fragment as digging tools, a hearty dwarf should be able to break through the west wall where another loose stone covers the beginnings of a previous excavation. Five to eight hours of diligent digging opens a way into the corridor west of the cell.

If the party includes a thief, he might be able to jimmy the bolt locking the peephole and reach across to pick the lock securing the cell at shoulder level. Since this task must be performed by touch alone, it will be difficult, but hardly impossible. Once the lock has been picked, a heavy item might be used to knock back the door bolt (which can't be jimmied). Be lenient here. If the players come up with a thoughtful and viable escape plan, they should be rewarded with success. All other cells except D5 are empty. Use the description for D4 as the basic description for all of the other cells in the dungeon.

D5. The Monk's Cell

Like the other cells, D5 is partly constructed of mortared stone and partly cut from the bedrock under the castle. The description of cell D4 will serve to convey its general appear-ance. In addition, the cell contains another feature:

> Lying face down in the center of the cell is a tonsured man in a white woolen monk's robe, now filthy and tattered. The entire back of the robe is stained a rusty brown. At a distance, the man looks thoroughly deceased.

If the characters enter the cell and examine the prisoner, they find that he is still alive, though barely so. If revivied and given drink to moisten his parched lips, he speaks.

> "Alas, brothers, I fear that you are too late. Already, I feel that coldness that so often presages the coming of the reaper. He cannot now be far from me, friends, so listen well. I have news that must reach the king's counselors. Know you, that there is much treachery abroad in this land, and now its hand has touched even that which all good men hold sacred.
>
> "I am called Theran, and I am a monk of Fontenmere. For long years have we loyally carried out the king's charge in our peaceful abbey, but now that is at an end. For red-handed death has fallen on our scented fields and quiet halls of prayer. Two days gone by, the abbey was attacked by the foulest of brigands. What may have been the outcome of their depredations I know not, for I was ordered by my master. the patriarch, to flee hence and beg succor from the king's liegeman at Montinelle.
>
> "Horror and death! Horror and death! E'en as I rode out on this fool's errand, one of the swine put an arrow deep in my back. 'Twas only the spirit and intelligence of my faithful mount that allowed me to come here at all. Bleeding and exhausted, with the screams of my brothers still ringing in my ears, I rode into Montinelle and laid my lord's charge before Sir Bracken. But the black-hearted scoundrel would not hear me. Instead of aid, he gave me this cell in which to die.
>
> "Aye. you understand too well. I can see it in your faces. The hired man, Bracken, would ne'er be so bold on his own. Such treachery must go deeper--to the very seat of Andevar and the person of the duke himself. Only orders from the lord of this place could have left me caged in this dungeon while murder was committed at Fontenmere Long has Aimar tended his anger against Fontenmere for the loss of lands that he deemed his own. Now it seems he has had his revenge.
>
> "Hear me, friends. I die now. But first I lay on you this charge. If you be true men of Dunador. ride now to Fontenmere and see what fate has befallen the king's abbey. The council must know of what happened there for Aimar's treason cannot possibly end at Fontenmere. Unless they are timely warned, I fear for our land. Unless..."

With this last word, the monk gives a rattling cough and dies. Since the monk suffers from blood poisoning, a *cure light wounds* spell does nothing to prolong his life. A *slow poison* spell will, however, prolong the monk's life, and he passes out instead of dying. Even if he remains alive, he is unable to provide additional information or assistance other than guiding the parry to Fontenmere. In fact, he is too weak to do much more than sit a horse. If revived, Theran is (AC 7; MV 12"; Mk 4; hp 16; #AT O; AL LN). A careful examination of the monk's robe reveals an object sewn into its hem. The item is a gold ring bearing the cross of Dunador; it is a *ring of protection +1*.

Leaving Montinelle

Any conspicuous attempt to leave Montinelle arouses the castle guards. If the parry has escaped after having been arrested, any visible attempt to leave the castle arouses the guards unless the characters are somehow disguised. Should the guards become aroused by an attempted exit, 4-16 guardsmen form a mounted pursuit group and try to overtake

and slay the parry. The mounted guardsmen have (AC 7; MV 24"; F4; hp 28; #AT 1; D1-6; AL LN). They carry lances and swords. Their mounts are (AC 7; MV 24 "; HD 2; hp 14; #AT 0; S L; AL N).

Once pursued, if the characters fail to maintain a 24" movement rate or if they do not take appropriate evasive action, the guards overtake them within 20 miles of Mon-tinelle. The guardsmen break off their pursuit after a 30-mile chase or if they lose two-thirds of their force.

While you are still well east of the abbey, it is obvious that all is not well. A wreath of pungent smoke hangs over the site. As you approach, details become clear. The wisps of smoke that float in the still air emanate from the burned-out ruin of a small wood and stone structure north of what appears to be the main building. The great doors in the south wall of this latter structure have been knocked off their hinges. Two dead men in white monks' robes are sprawled on the front steps before the doors. Their bodies have been savaged by some animal. All of the visible windows have been wholly and partially smashed. Your view of the interior through the open doorway shows a vista of smashed pews and debris.

1. Office

The door to this chamber is smashed open and the chamber devastated. All of the furniture is smashed to kindling and torn papers and rare illuminated manuscripts are scattered amid the wreckage.

There is nothing of real interest here.

2. Monks' Living Quarters

The four beds in this spartan chamber have been overturned and their straw tifcks have been slashed open. There is a movement in the southeast corner.

Disturbed by the noise, two large spiders which have only recently entered the chamber through the broken window in the east wall crawl out from under some debris in the corner. Each has (AC 6; MV 18"; HD 2 +2; hp 17. 15; #AT 1; D 1-6 c poison 2; AL N). A victim bitten by a spider must save vs. poison at + 1 or die within six rounds. Hidden by the debris is a chest containing 400 gp.

3. Writing Room

The door to this chamber is open. Six tall writing desks lay toppled over on the floor of this chamber. Many writing materials-quill pens, ink wells, papers, and blotters -- lie scattered about the room. The lifeless body of a monk is slumped against the south wall.

The monk has been hacked to death with swords. On the floor beside the body is the word "Capel," written in a mixture of spilled ink and blood. This clue indicates that the royal seal and scepter of Dunador have been spirited away to Capel Tower. Before dying, the monk heard one of the "brigands" make a reference to this fortification in the north of Andevar.

4. Monks' Quarters

The smashed remnants of four twisted bedsteads and four splintered footlockers lie scattered about this chamber. A dozen savagely torn monks' habits and the ticking from the beds is strewn across the stone flags.

A careful examination of the room uncovers a flat wooden case under one of the beds in the southwest corner. The case holds a magical *crossbow +1*.

5. West Chapel

This antechamber seems almost intact. The altar in the center of the room seems undamaged, though it lacks its normal adornment. Even the prayer benches remain in place. Their kneeling cushions have, however, been ripped open and the stuffings scattered about the floor.

There is nothing of interest here.

6. East Chapel

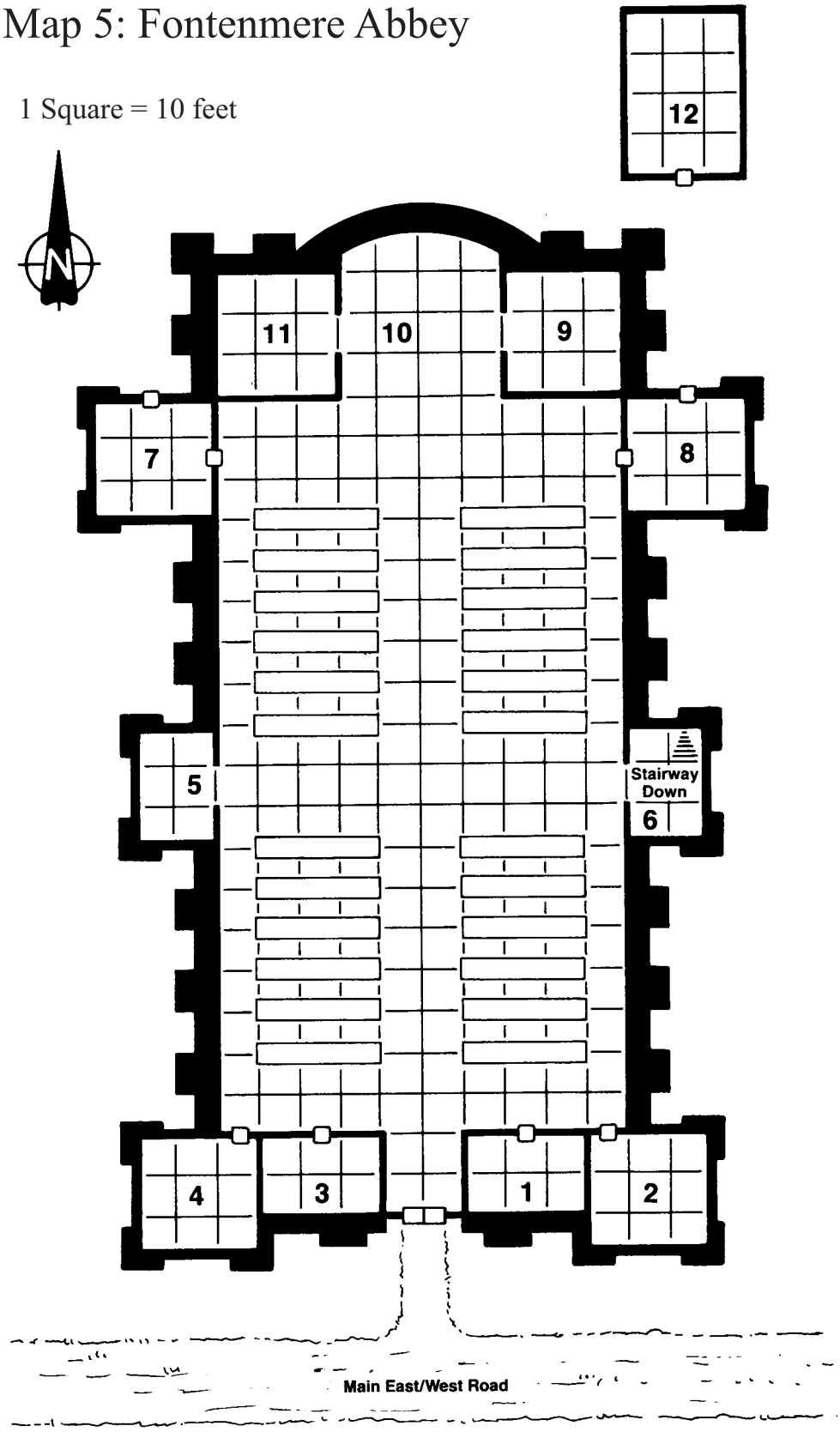
The altar piece in this chapel is unharmed though, like the others at Fontenmere, it lacks its altar cloth and service. A trap door in the floor has been ripped open to reveal a flight of stairs leading into the blackness below.

The stairs end in an open door. This area is a single-room wine cellar (30x30 feet). Standing behind the door is a thief named Menlow. armed with a short sword. Having heard the party above and having no escape route, he intends to ambush whomever comes into the room. Menlow is (AC 7; MV 12"; T4; #AT 1; D 1-6; AL CN). He attempts one surprise attack from the rear. If outnumbered or overmatched, the pragmatic Menlow surrenders after making this one attack and begs for mercy.

Menlow wears leather armor and carries the following in his pack: two bottles of good quality wine; two altar cloths (50 gp each); two gold goblets that bear the abbey's insignia (50 gp each); a golden cross of Dunador (150 gp); and a set of thief's tools. Hidden in a leather pouch inside his tunic he carries 10 gp. 40 sp. and a parchment in the form of a letter addressed to "Holland at Dunthrane." This brief handwritten note reads as follows.

Map 5: Fontenmere Abbey

1 Square = 10 feet



Honored Friend,

There is grave news. I have learned that Lord Edrin's men-at-arms have entered Andevar. Through an arrangement with the duke, they have made their headquarters at Capel Tower along our northern border. The location is, as we both well know, an ideal base for scouting the trails through the Veronian Mountains. I fear now for the Prince's safety. Take care and look to yourself.

Your Devoted Friend,
William

The letter is obviously from William Menote to Hollend. Its authenticity can be established beyond doubt by comparing the handwriting to that of any documents in the patriarch's chamber (room 8).

Menlow has looted this leather pouch from the body of a monk who was preparing to leave for Dunthrane when the brigands (Lord Edrin's men in disguise) attacked. although also a chief in his own right, Menlow is currently acting as an agent of Sir Bracken, the commander of the Duke of Andevar's castle at Montinelle. At Bracken's order, he has come to Fontenmere to investigate the report of this attack. Having established the facts in the matter, he is to meet Kirkroy. the Duke's champion. at Barbarian's Bridge (north of Capel Tower) and report his findings. From the patriarch's letter and his own observations, Menlow is rightly convinced that Lord Edrin's men are responsible for sacking the abbey.

Menlow's cover is that he is a thief returning to Andevar from the far west. If bribed or threatened, this is the story that he offers the party. If pressed further, he provides details. claiming to be heading for the Drake & Castle Inn to stay with a distant cousin. He even identifies Graf, the innkeeper at the Drake & Castle, by name. If he is able to lull the party's suspicions, Menlow, pretending to be talkative, advises them to avoid the open road east of Montinelle since "it be a'crawl wi' brigands" and advises them to take the covered route through the Lusian Forest instead. He well knows that no one familiar with the area would go through the dreaded Darkwood and considers this bit of misdirection quite clever. If an astute member of the parry wonders how someone returning from the west knows so much about the roads to the east, Menlow becomes flustered and shuts up.

Unless challenged concerning his information, Menlow is quite affable with party members, in an effort to lull them into complacency. Whether sullen or affable, however, the thief takes the first available

opportunity to escape if detained by the characters. If successful in this endeavor, he meets Kirkroy at the end of three days and reports on events at the abbey and the presence of the party in Andevar.

Menlow knows nothing about Griffon Castle or the whereabouts of Duke Aimar.

7. Chapter House

This chamber bears all the coats-of-arms of Dunador on its walls. All of the shields and banners are undisturbed except for one: the banner of the royal house of Dunthrane, which lies draped over the body of a dead monk. The royal insignia bears the light blue symbols of the crown, the sword, and the Dunadorian cross on a field of canary yellow.

8. Patriarch's Chamber

This finely appointed chamber appears to be a combination office and bedroom. A small but comfortable-looking bed occupies the southeast corner. There is a small writing desk beside it. Floor-to-ceiling bookcases are built into the wall on either side of the door. Their contents have been tumbled onto the floor. A large chest lies overturned in the center of the chamber. Amongst the debris littering the floor is the body of a monk wearing a white robe trimmed in red.

The body is that of William Menote, Patriarch of Fontenmere, a supposition which the players can easily verify by checking the portrait of William Menote carried by the party's leader. Within eight rounds of entering the room, everyone must save vs. spell or flee the chamber in terror. Those who stay see a ghostly figure rise from the dead patriarch's body. The transparent figure hovers for a moment and then speaks in a quiet but eerie voice.

"I am the spirit of William Menote, once patriarch of Fontenmere... now murdered. Know you, mortals, that I appear before you because I cannot rest. An outrage has been committed here, a desecration beyond all enduring. The royal seal and scepter of Dunador have been stolen by the forces of darkness. These things must be returned. They must be brought back! Without them, there can be no coronation, and no king in Dunador. Without our king, there can be no peace, neither for the living of Dunador nor for the dead of Fontenmere!

So saying, the patriarch utters a wail of despair and disappears. Viewing this spirit does not cause unnatural fear or aging.

A small cloth pouch is tacked to the bottom of the patriarch's writing desk. It holds a clerical *ring of spell storing* with four spells: *remove curse*, *cure serious wounds*, *dispel magic*, and *spiritual hammer*. The ring can be used by anyone and can be recharged.

9. The Royal Chapel

The walls of this chapel are broken by rows of niches, each containing a fine alabaster carving of one of the kings of Dunador. Each carving stands 5 feet high, and the name of the king it represents is etched in the wall above the effigy in the common tongue of the kingdom. One of the statues has been smashed and the nave above it partly scratched out. On the east wall, an iron grid has been ripped away from a recess in the scene. A finely embroidered purple cushion rests on a bare marble plinth in the center of the otherwise empty cavity.

It should be clear to the players that this is the chamber that once held the royal seal and scepter of Dunador. The broken statue is that of King Halfred.

10. Main Altar

A long, semicircular stone altar rests flush against the north wall. A blue and gold altar cloth covers the fixture. The altar is topped by a large silver cross. There is a small marble font next to the altar.

The cross is typical of Dunadorian design, having heavy balls at the end of each arm. It is worth 500 gp. Hidden in a secret compartment in the base of the altar is a *Superior Master's Manual of Bodily Health*. Any monk who studies this book is cured of 3-6 points of damage and all diseases and adds 1 point to his or her Constitution score. A complete reading of the manual requires one week.

11. Lady Chapel

As you are entering this chapel, you are startled by the muffled sound of a grunt from the northwest corner. There is a strong animal smell in the air, and there are coarse hairs caught in the splintered frame of the door by which you are entering the chamber.

A giant boar has recently entered this chamber in search of food. The creature is (AC 6; MV 12"; HD 7; hp 46; #AT 1; D 3-18; AL N). Trapped inside the chamber by the party's presence, it fights to the death.

This chamber was in the process of being renovated when the abbey was sacked. Scaffolding lines the south wall. The various statues and carvings have been cleaned with a lime wash treatment to restore them to their original color. The acid used in this process is not strong enough for use as a weapon. In the northwest corner is a pile of rags and miscellaneous small files and other tools. Among the rags is a leather pouch filled with 400 gp worth of gold chips used for doing gold inlay.

A careful examination of the stone and wood debris in the southeast corner uncovers a metal arm brace bearing a small insignia in the shape of a raven. The brace was dropped by one of Edrin's men. It is a clue to the true identities of the brigands.

12. Kitchen House

This building has been razed almost to the ground. Amid the jumble of charred beams and broken, blackened stones are the skeletal remains of half a dozen bodies.

The bodies are the mortal remains of four monks and two servants who sought refuge inside the kitchen house and were burned out by the brigands. A careful search uncovers an iron box containing 40 pp and a small oilskin bag filled with a soft resin. This substance is a special *detoxin*. If applied to any poisonous bite or wound with eight rounds, it neutralizes all ill effects. There are three applications in the bag. The detoxin may be used externally only. A monk will know the properties of the resin and a cleric has a base chance of 60% to identify it.

Behind the gutted building is a small but dense stand of trees. Hidden in this tiny wood is a horse, tethered to a tree. This animal, a medium war horse (AC 7; MV 18; HD 2 + 2; hp 17; #AT 3, D 1-6/1- 6/1-3; AL N). belongs to Menlow, the thief. In the horse's saddle bags are iron rations for a week, normal provisions for a week, pots, pans, clothes, and a bedroll. At the bottom of one of the bags is a blue-enameled copper brooch used to fasten a cloak. The brooch is engraved with the golden lion insignia of the Duke of Andevar.

Open Road

(Only if the group has first gone to Montinelle; then to the Abbey)

If the characters have visited Montinelle and been identified as hostile to the duke or otherwise suspicious, there is one patrol of the duke's men looking for them on the main road from west of Montinelle to the Drake and Castle Inn. If the group moves northeast on the main road from Fontenmere, they are certain to encounter this patrol which is easily identified by their livery (the blue tunic with gold lion of the Duke of Aimar). The horsemen fight to the death. They include:

1 sergeant: AC 5; MV 24"; F4; hp 36, #AT 1; D 1-8 (sword); AL N
The sergeant carries 1-20 gp.

9 troopers: AC 6, MV 24"; F3; hp 22; #AT 1; D 1-6 (lance); AL N
Each trooper carries 1-20 gp and a sword.

10 light horses: AC 7; MV 24"; HD 2; hp 13 each; #AT Nil; S L; AL N

The Darkwood is a dangerous place. If the party chooses to follow this path, it should be a memorable experience. Make three wandering monster checks; one for every 15 miles of the group's progress through the forest. An encounter occurs on a roll of 1 or 2 on Idb. The exact nature of the encounter is found on the Lusian Forest Wandering Monster Table.

Lusian Forest Wandering Monster Table

Roll	Result
1	Skeletons (10): AC 7; MV 12"; hp 8 each; HD 1; #AT 1; D 1-6 (short sword); AL N
2	Wraiths(3): AC 4; MV 12 "/ 24 "; hp 18, 22, 23; HD 5+3; #AT 1; D 1-6 (*energy drain*); AL E
3	Zombies (8): AC 8; MV 6", hp 9, 11, 13, 13, 14, 15, 15, 16; HD 2; #AT 1; D 1-8; AL N
4	Zombies (6): AC 8; MV 6"; hp 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16; HD 2; #AT 1; D 1-8; AL N
5	Wights (4): AC 5; MV 12"; hp 16, 17, 13, 24; HD 4+3; #AT 1; D 1-4 (*energy drain*); AL E
6	Wights (2): AC 5, MV 12"; hp 22, 24; HD 4+3; #AT 1; D 1-4 (*energy drain*); AL E

The Lusian Forest Wandering Monster Table is used only when the party is within the Lusian Forest.

Menlow does not willingly accompany the party into the Lusian Forest. Only if bound or closely guarded does he stay with the party when they enter this area. However, once inside the forest, Menlow, realizing that his only hope of survival lies with the party, willingly throws in his lot with them. He fights alongside the characters and uses his skills on their behalf (without ever, however, admitting that he has any knowledge of the forest's wicked reputation). As soon as the party is out of the forest, Menlow again tries to escape. He does not willingly visit the Drake and Castle Inn because of his fear that his talkative cousin will accidentally give him away.

Upon reaching the midpoint of their journey through the woods, read the following passage to the players:

> You have been traveling through this dense forest for many miles. Your horses seem uneasy and your own spirits droop as you ride deeper and deeper into the dim and brooding wood. At length, you come to a widening in the roadway. In the midst of a clearing grows a huge, ancient tree whose arching limbs cast the otherwise open area into deep shadow. Its twisted, gnarled trunk exhibits numerous imperfections and holes. Scattered about the tree bole are the skeletons, armor, and rotting garments of a number of humans or humanoids. Many of the skeletal figures grip rusting weapons. The air is deathly still and somehow oppressive. Each of you is consumed by an overpowering feeling of dread.

The tree trunk is the dark resting place of a groaning spirit (AC O; MV 15 "; HD 7; hp 36; D 1-8 (touch); SA wail; AL CE). Entering the 25-foot by 25-foot clearing causes the groaning spirit to emanate from one of the holes in the tree. The sight of this entity forces everyone in the party to save vs. spells or flee in terror back down the road and out of earshot. The groaning spirit attacks with its chilling touch. On a roll of 1 or 2 on 1d6, it wails once. Whoever hears this terrible sound must save vs. death or die on the spot. The groaning spirit is immune to cold or electricity attacks and also to the following spells: *charm*, *sleep*, and *hold*. A successful exorcism kills the groaning spirit.

This entity is the undead spirit of a female elf, once known as *Lusian*. A dabbler in the black arts, she brought ruination on the elven community who dwelt in this wood before the time of man. So wicked was she that the elven god, Rillifane Rallathil, bound her to this fate after death. The undead in this wood are the spirits of her victims. The skeletons around the tree are the remains of passing adventurers. Some aspiring knights and warriors of Dunador, having thought to perform their rite of passage" by riding through the Darkwood, have paid for their arrogance with their lives. If the groaning spirit is destroyed, the wood becomes peaceful again.

A careful search of the debris and weaponry surrounding the tree reveals a magical *shield +1*. Inside the tree trunk is a chest containing 4,000 gp, a *potion of undead control (wraiths)*, and a magic user's scroll *lightning bolt*. At the base of the tree trunk, there is a long sword in a scabbard. A detailed inscription on the blade identifies it as a *sword +1, +2 against magic-using or enchanted creatures* (including magic users, spell-casting monsters, created or summoned creatures.

The Drake & Castle Inn

The Drake & Castle Inn is the only stopover for travelers along the main road between Montinelle and the Northlands, and also does a small, but profitable business serving pilgrims bound for the Shrine of Nevron. As the party approaches the inn they see three horses and a pack mule tied up outside the front entrance. Two horses and the mule stand apart from the third horse.

If the party investigates the animals, they discover that the two horses and the mule belong to two merchants. The animals' saddle bags and packs literally bulge with linens, silks, cheap trinkets, and jewelry. The third horse carries two saddle bags. One bag contains a sleeping roll and ordinary personal items. The other bag holds a set of thief's tools, a throwing dagger provisions, and at the bottom of the bag, a small leather pouch. The pouch contains a small silver icon engraved with the insignia of Fontenmere Abbey.

There are four people at the inn; a barman behind the curving bar, two merchants at the round table, and a figure sitting at the booth in the southeast corner, huddled deep in his dark, hooded cloak and trying quite unsuccessfully to look inconspicuous.

Graf the innkeeper: AC7; MV 9"; F3; hp 22; #AT 1; D 1-6 (club); AL N
Treat him as if he wears leather armor because of his heavy serving clothes.

In most respects, Graf is a true neutral. His business depends on it. However, for 2 gp per question, he will provide the following answers (or whatever variation seems appropriate) in an oily and ingratiating voice:

Pilgrims! Why certainly, good sirs. Pilgrims are something one sees a lot of at the Drake & Castle. Why, just a bit over a week ago I had one rather curious party in here. On their way to Nevron, of course. Nothing unusual in chat, but they seemed too fine to be common folk. More like royalty, if you catch my drift.

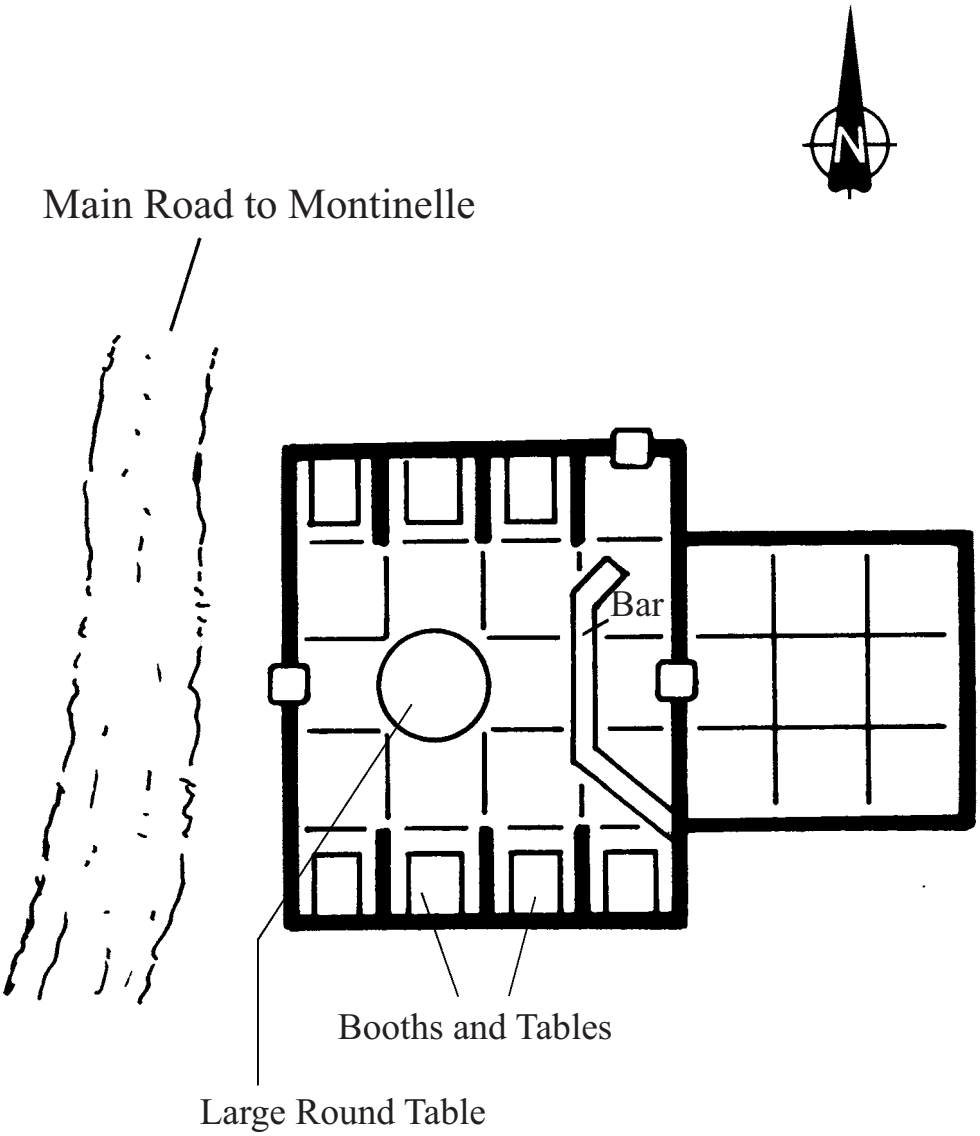
Riders! Why now that you ask, there was one rather large parry of riders that passed by last week. Why, yes. In fact, it was just an hour or so after that party of pilgrims I told you about. Very strange business. I remember, because, you see, they didn't stop in here. Unusual. This being the only inn between the Three Feathers and the Boar's Bride up by Coldwater in the Northlands, it's not often that a party just rides on by. Something else unusual, too. Hot weather last week. Very hot. But they were all bundled up in heavy cloaks, and under the cloaks you could see blue tunics peeking out as they rode. Now, I ask you, who, in that kind of weather, wears a tunic and a heavy cloak!

Yes, well now, Capel Tower. No mystery there. Just stay on the north road here instead of taking the turnoff to Nevron. That'll take you right to the tower with no trouble. Its right on the River Laine, just about 40 miles north of here. Hardly any distance at all for gentlemen such as yourselves.

Menlow! Hmmm. Uh, yes. I do have a cousin named Menlow. No close relation. you understand. Haven't seen him in some time now. Last I heard, he was in Montinelle in the duke's service. Actually, we all hoped that would straighten him out a bit, but I don't suppose it has. The boy was always a miserable little sneak.

Map 6: The Drake & Castle Inn

1 square = 10 feet



If Menlow is present with the party, he tries (by hand motions or facial expressions) to signal Graf to help him, but Graf assumes that his blacksheep cousin is in on some secret business and is indicating that he would like to have his presence ignored. Thus, he studiously pretends not to recognize Menlow until openly confronted with his presence. Under no circumstances does Graf help Menlow escape.

Merchants (2): AC 7; MV 9"; F2; hp 10, 12; #AT 1; D 1-6 (short swords); capes and leather tunics; AL N

Between them, these two merchants, Fenn and Swaine, carry 115 gp. They are traveling to Montinelle from the far north to do some business. If questioned, they remember having yesterday seen a motley band of hard-riding horsemen who passed them heading north on the main road just this side of the River Laine. The incident sticks in their minds because the riders looked like brigands, causing Fenn and Swaine to take momentary fright and hide in some bushes, a state of affairs which both men now view with rueful humor.

If the players do not at first catch the significance of the merchants' story, make it clear that the group of riders they are describing were nothing like those described by Graf. Graf's group appeared to be soldiers of some sort, while the merchants' group seemed to be brigands.

The soldiers were the Duke of Andevar's men who seized the prince. The second group (brigands) are Lord Edrin's men who sacked Fontenmere Abbey and made off with the royal seal and scepter of Dunador. The Duke's men have ridden north of the River Laine while Edrin's men are at the Capel Tower.

Harkin: AC 4; MV 12 "; T4; hp 21; #AT 1; D 2-9 (long sword +1); AL E

The man in the corner is a thief named Harkin, a member of Edrin's group of "brigands" that sacked Fontenmere. He wears *bracers of defense AC 6*, a leather jerkin, and carries 40 gp in a pouch around his waist. As soon as the characters begin to question the others, Harkin makes as if to leave the inn. Finding the group suspicious, he intends to ride to Capel Tower and inform Edrin's chief henchman, Mendal Secord, about the group's presence in Andevar. If questioned or confronted, Harkin attacks without warning, trying to cut a way clear to his horse which is tethered outside. If unable to escape, he fights to the death. However, an ESP spell reveals that he is one of Edrin's "brigands" and that the royal seal and scepter of Dunador are at Capel Tower. He does not know where the prince is.

Layout of the Inn

Stools stand in front of the semicircular bar. Behind the bar is a tall shelving unit stocked with all types of wines and spirits. Under the bar are several casks filled with ale of various quality. Graf also provides bread and cheese to hungry wayfarers. Drake & Castle prices: ale 17 cp, beer 8 cp, mead 8 sp, wine 10 sp, other spirits 12 sp a glass, and Graf's ploughman's lunch of bread and cheese 1 gp.

Graf's room is at the back of the inn through a door behind the bar. The chamber contains a bed, table, and two straight-back chairs, and a pair of footlockers. One footlocker contains odds and ends of clothing and personal items. The other footlocker contains a suit of chain mail armor, a shield, and a *long sword +1*. Graf's life savings are secreted in an old chest hidden under the bed beneath the floor boards. The chest contains 200 gp, 400 sp, and 2,000 cp.

At the back of the inn, tethered in a sort of lean-to, is Graf's old horse.

Horse: AC 7; HD 2 + 2; MV 18"; hp 9; #AT Nil. AL N

A small, free-standing enclosure behind the inn contains about two dozen chickens. A goat is tethered to a nearby post.

Leaving the Drake & Castle Inn

Before they leave the inn, Graf repeats his instructions for reaching Capel Tower. If the characters ask about the Shrine of Nevron, he informs them that travel on horseback is not possible in the higher reaches of the Veronian Mountains. Graf sells the characters any provisions they need at normal prices.

If the characters proceed to Nevron, read this passage to them.

> From the turning in the main road, the small track to Nevron winds its way along forested foothills rich with the scent of pine and fir tree. As the path winds ever higher up into the Veronian Mountains, the gently rolling hills give way to steeper, granite-faced cliffs and misty hollows.

When the characters reach a spot about 10 miles due southwest of the shrine, read this passage.

> As the trail continues to wind up the steep sides of the mountains, the footing becomes more and more treacherous and uneven. You approach an out-jutting lip of rock, forming a sort of natural shelter. Ahead. you can see that the path narrows, weaving in and out between cowering rock formations and ascending abruptly.

At this point, mounted progress is no longer possible. You should point this out to the characters and suggest that this is a good place to tether their horses in relative safety.

For the last 10 miles, the characters have to climb about 2,000 feet to reach the shrine at an elevation of 6,000 feet. As the party passes through the wooded area indicated on the Shrine of Nevron map, they are surprised by a marauding cave bear whose disposition has been unbalanced by the coming of spring. Driven into a frenzy by its derangement, the bear fights to the death.

Bear: AC 6, MV 12 "; HD 6 c 6; hp 55; #AT 3; D 1-8, 1-8, 1-12; SA hugs for 2-16; S L; AL N

If the characters search the vicinity, they find the bear's den 60 feet due east of this encounter location. Among a pile of bones near the cave mouth is a rotting leather satchel. Barely contained by the rotting material is a cache of gold nuggets worth 300 gp. this trove of an unfortunate dwarven miner who fell victim to the bear.

The Shrine of Nevron

After climbing many hundreds of feet on the narrow path, at last you come to a level area like a small plateau surrounded by steep-faced cliffs. At the north end of this natural basin is a large cave mouth 20 feet wide and 10 feet high. In front of the cave, anchored atop a large, flat rock, is a cross of Dunador.

The cross is made of oak and sunk part way into the rock. There is nothing to keep the characters from entering the cave mouth. Once they do so, they see the following:

From the cliff-side entrance, a long, deep cave with irregular 10-foot high ceiling, stretches into the darkness. The sound of running water resonates throughout the cavern. Dimly visible in the darkness is a crystal rock formation by the north wall. A fountain-like stream of water gushes forth from the rock and tumbles into a catchpool in front. Thousands of tiny lights wink and sparkle in the crystal rock formation like so many imprisoned fireflies.

The characters may approach the rock and fountain at their leisure.

As the characters are about to leave the cave (or when anyone tampers with the crystal), a shaft of golden light emanates form inside the crystal rock. Characters of neutral or evil alignment are instantly turned from the cave. Characters of good alignment experience the following telepathic communication:

Listen seeker, for I am the Oracle of Nevron and I know why you have come. You seek the true heir to this kingdom. He is in grave danger. Look for him in the west where the waters flow... where the bird meets the lion.

Having said this, the oracle is silent, and the odd golden light fades into darkness.

The last two lines of the oracle's message are references to Griffon Castle (a griffon is part bird and part lion). It also has a double meaning, referring to the lion symbol of Aimar and the raven symbol of Lord Edrin, the evil alliance.

Drinking the Water of Nevron

Any clerics of good alignment who drink the water improve their Wisdom scores by 1. However, thereafter, they also become lawful good in alignment.

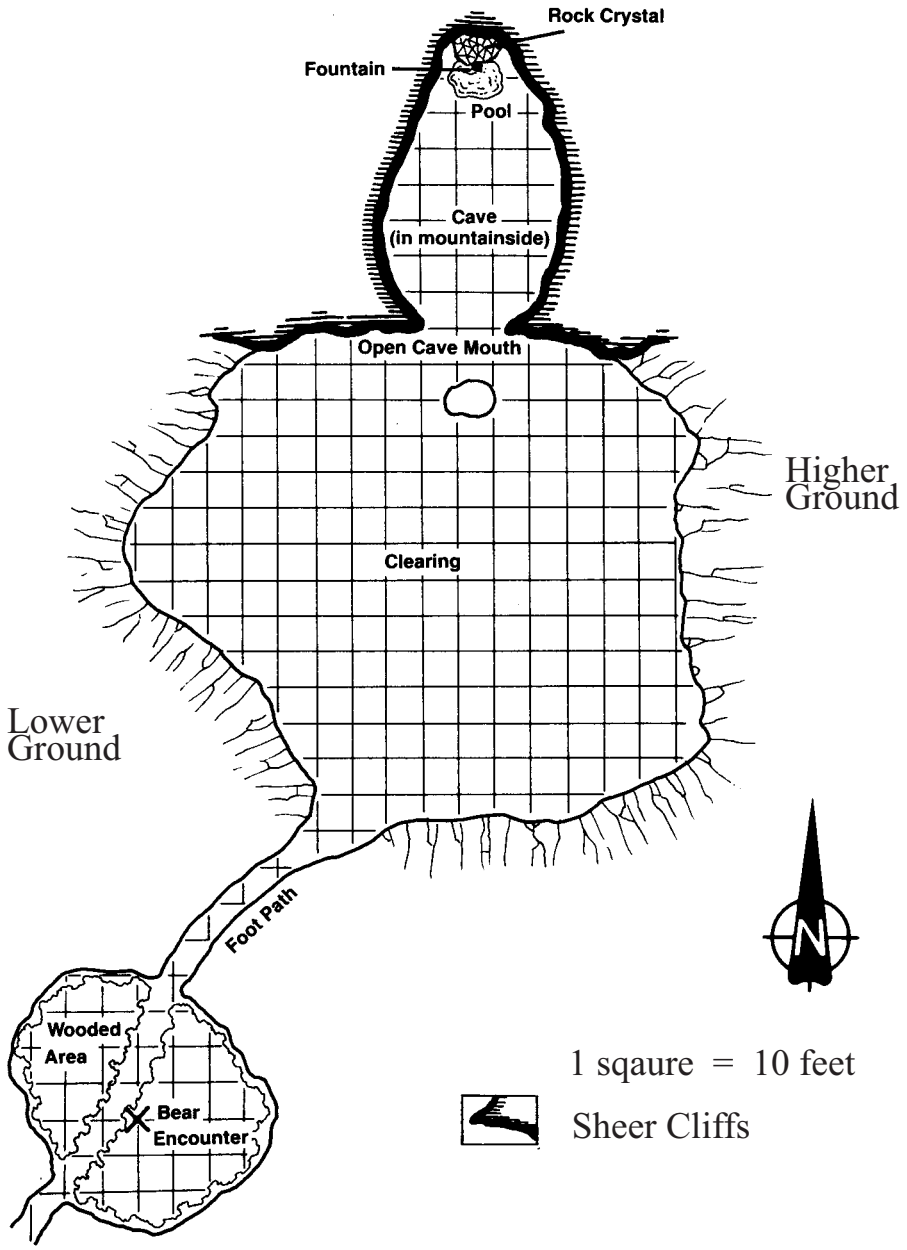
The leader of the group, if a fighter or fighter multiclass of good alignment, may improve his or her Strength score by 1 by drinking the water. Once again, though, this character's alignment changes to lawful good, if applicable.

Paladins who drink the water add 1 point to both Wisdom and Strength scores.

Individuals suffering an alignment change as a result of drinking the waters of Nevron lose one level of experience, as described on page 25 of the DMG. All characters who drink the waters are considered to have suffered an "involuntary" alignment change, even if they have observed the waters' effect on those who drank before them. Characters will have their ability scores or alignments affected only once by the waters of Nevron in this adventure.

Persons other than those mentioned above neither benefit from drinking the water nor suffer an alignment change from doing so. Persons of evil alignment, however, feel nauseated after drinking.

Map 7: The Shrine of Nevron



The Capel Tower

The Capel Tower is a fortification located three miles south of the River Laine. As part of Dunador's northern defense, the tower is under Duke Aimar's jurisdiction, but subject to royal policy and use. Currently, as pan of Edrin's and Aimar's secret alliance, Lord Edrin's men are using Capel Tower as their base of operation in Andevar. All of the tower's occupants are human, and all are in Edrin's service except for the steward, the kitchen servant and the turnkey, who are Aimar's men.

Roster: The Capel Tower Roster lists all guards at the Capel Tower. Each guard wears a dark gray tunic emblazoned with Edrin's black raven device.

Capel Tower Roster

Class/Level	AL	Weapons	Combat Bonus	Armor	AC	hp
F4	LE	sword, bow	+1 with bow	chain & shield	5	33
F5	LE	sword, bow		chain & shield	4	41
F3	LE	spear, crossbow	+1 with X-bow	splint	6	22
F2	LE	spear, sword		ring	7	14
F4	LE	sword, crossbow		chain	6	28
F3	LE	axe, sword	+1 with axe	leather	8	24
F4	LE	axe, mace		chain & shield	6	36
F2	LE	axe, dagger		chain & shield	4	17
F3	LE	sword, flail	+1 with sword	splint & shield	5	21
F5	LE	bow, dagger	+1 with bow	chain	6	40
F5	LE	bow, mace	+1 with bow	splint	6	38
F4	LE	bow, sword		chain	6	30
F3	LE	bow, sword	+1 with bow	leather	7	22
F4	LE	sword, spear		chain & shield	5	30
F3	LE	crossbow, mace	+1 with X-bow	ring	6	26
F5	LE	bow, dagger	+1 with bow	chain	6	46

Each guard carries 2-40 sp and 1-10 gp. Station these men-at-arms as needed, consistent with the encounter descriptions that follow.

Capel Tower sits only a few hundred feet west of the main road, facing east toward the mountains. Constructed of large blocks of mossy limestone, its square mass is surrounded by a 10-foot-deep, weed-choked moat fed by an underground spring During daylight, the drawbridge is down, but so is the portcullis. At night, the drawbridge is up and covers the entrance arch.

The tower steward and four men-at-arms are always at the front entrance, they stop and question anyone seeking entry. If the characters arrive at the Chapel Tower unannounced and state that they have important information for the tower's commander or devise a similar story, the steward lets them in. Otherwise, he sends them on their way. Persistent attempts to get into the tower after having once been denied entry results in arrow attacks from the walls. The men at Capel Tower are in a constant state of combat readiness.

If Harkin the thief from the Drake and Castle Inn, arrives at Capel Tower before the party. he informs the guards of the parry's presence in the area. In this case, when the characters arrive at the tower, its occupants invite them to enter and ambushes them in the courtyard (2.).

The tower's parapets are 40 feet high and the four small guard towers are 54 feet high at the corners. At any one time, there is one guard in each guard tower and two guards patrolling the open-air parapets atop the walls of the main tower. In the event of open hostilities, mobilize all the men-at-arms in a way consistent with an intelligent and spirited defense of the tower. Ten of the guards. for instance, have crossbows or bows. These men would naturally fire arrows from the walls or turret tops.

The Moat

The moat contains six giant leeches (AC 9; MV 3"; HD 1; hp 8 each; #AT 1; D 1-4; SA drain blood; AL N). The leeches attach themselves to a victim (1-4)and drain one point of blood per round until knocked off or killed. There is only a 1% chance that the victim is aware of the creatures' attack because of the leeches' anesthetizing saliva. There is a 50% chance that the bite causes a disease which, if left untreated, is fatal in 2-5 weeks.

Capel Tower: Level I

1. Entrance and Gatehouse

There are four guards on duty behind the lowered portcullis. Any attempted intrusion causes them to summon Sigmund, the tower steward, from his office (5). Sigmund is (AC 3; MV 9"; F4' hp 28; #Att 1; D 1-8 (sword); AL LN). He wears no livery. Instead, the breastplate of his fine plate mail armor is emblazoned with Duke Aimar's golden lion insignia. He carries 1-20 gp in a pouch and wears a silver chain of office around his neck.

A pair of winches inside the gatehouse control the drawbridge and portcullis.

2. Open-Air Courtyard

Many covered water barrels stand near the walls around this courtyard. The walls are pierced here and there with narrow windows. There are no other features of note.

3a. and 3b. Stables

There are 14 horses at the tower, seven in each stable. Each stable contains 10 small, cramped stalls.

4. Jailer's Office

> A shriveled little old man in an ancient suit of leather armor sits at a rough oak plank desk against the wet wall. He halfheartedly sharpens a rusty-looking short sword. In the floor next to the west wall is an open trap door.

The aged gentleman is Oswald, the turnkey. He is (AC 8; MV 6"; F4. #AT 1; D 1-6 (short sword); AL LN). Around his neck he wears a pouch containing 1-10 sp and a large key which unlocks the door to the dungeon below. Being so old. Oswald would rather sound the alarm than fight. If unable to summon help, he tries to surrender if it looks as if his life might be spared.

A spiral staircase leads from the trap door to the dungeon below. A deep drawer in the desk holds iron rations and a half-empty flask of mead.

D1. Dungeon Level

> The spiral staircase leads to a dank limestone corridor, featureless except for a heavy door at its eastern end. The door's oak planks are pierced by a single barred window.

Behind the door is a cell holding a pair of simple farmers, incarcerated for being late to pay their taxes. If questioned by the characters, the farmers are unable to provide meaningful information. However, they indicate that they know someone who can be of more help: Eli the huntsman, considered by the local peasantry to be the wisest man north of Fontenmere. According to the farmers, Eli

lives on the north short of the River Laine, about a mile west of the bridge (note map for players).

5. Steward's Office

This circular chamber is dominated by a narrow, stone spiral staircase in its center. A battered old desk occupies the south wall. Above it hangs the duke's golden lion coat-of-arms. A small rack of lances stands near the west wall. A rumpled bed and a footlocker against the east wall complete the room's furnishing.

The staircase leads to room 15.

The desk's center drawer contains a mundane assortment of papers detailing the stores currently held in the tower. The locked footlocker contains a battle axe, a shield, two long swords, and a sack holding 300 sp. The lance rack against the west wail holds six lances.

Sewn inside Sigmund's mattress is a small leather pouch containing five pearls and six rubies (each worth 30 gp).

6. Barracks

A spiral staircase winds up through the center of this chamber. Placed symmetrically about this chamber are eight narrow beds. The head of each rests against the wall; the foot points toward the central spiral staircase. At the foot of each bed is a sturdy-looking footlocker.

The staircase leads to room 13.

The footlockers are unlocked. Each contains articles of clothing. One of them contains 1-20 sp tied up in an old rag. Another contains 1-20 sp in a small leather pouch

7. Barracks

A spiral staircase winds up through th center of this chamber. Placed symmetrically about this chamber are eight narrow beds. The head of each rests against the wall; the foot points reward the central staircase. At the foot of each bed is a sturdy-looking footlocker.

The staircase leds to room 11.

The footlockers contain clothing and other personal items. the footlocker nearest the exit door contains a gorgeous linen altar cloth embroidered with the emblem of Fontenmere Abbey (30gp).

8. Armory

This room is obviously an armory. Lining ics curved walls are many racks of efficient looking and brightly-polished weapons. Spears, lances, javelins, crossbows, and long bows abound. In the gaps between weapons racks are four iron-bound chests. The spiral stairs in the center of the room lead up to a trap door in the ceiling which is closed with a deadbolt.

Each of the five racks hold 16 weapons. The easternmost chest contains 50 heavy iron spikes. Moving clockwise around the room, the other chests contain 200 crossbow bolts. 300 arrows, and 6 grappling hooks (each with 50 feet of rope attached) respectively.

The trap door leads to room 9.

Capel Tower: Level II

9. Storeroom
The doors to this storeroom are locked.

> The floor of this room is amply occupied by six upright barrels. Against the walls are racks filled with scaled kegs.

Three barrels hold wine; the others hold drinking water. There are four kegs each of ale, brandy, and mead. There are no spiral stairs in this room. The trap door in the floor is locked from below by a dead bolt.

10. Cookhouse

> A large, grimy brick oven occupies the north wall. It is flanked on either side by a stack of mealy bags. The south wall is lined with scarred wooden counters. Beneath them are a number of produce bins stuffed with fresh vegetables. All manner of cooking utensils litter the counters and hang from heavy iron hooks in the ceiling beams. Standing at one corner is a large man in breeches, shirt, and cloth apron. He is using a cleaver to bone a brace of hares.

The mealy bags contain flour and grain. The man with the cleaver is Dewey, the household servant and caretaker assigned to Capel Tower by Aimar. Dewey is a simple-minded, but good-natured soul who neither fights nor raises an alarm. He speaks with the parry happily and at length, but he knows absolutely nothing of importance...not even the exact number or whereabouts of the guards.

11. Servants' Tower Room

> This is a mean, dirty chamber, barely recognizable as a human habitation. Its only furnishing is a pair of cots set against the north wall. Four three-pronged grappling hooks with their coiled ropes attached hang from an iron bracket set into the west wall. In the northeast corner is a stack of lumber. A spiral staircase leads to an unsecured trap door in the ceiling.

This chamber is the servants' quarters for Oswald and Dewey. Under each man's cot is a bag of clothing and one or two meager personal possessions. The sack under Oswald's cor contains 4-80 cp and 2-12 sp. Each of the grappling hooks on the west wail have 50 feet of rope attached.

The spiral staircase leads up to room 18 and down to room 7.

12. Guards' Mess

> A long, wood-plank table, flanked by a pair of benches, occupies the center of this room. It is set with sixteen mugs, plates, and cutlery sets. A tired-looking, old hound is asleep under the table near the north entry.

If it is dinner time (6 p.m. to 7 p.m.) and no alert has been sounded, eight of the tower guards are seated at the table, making inroads in the savory contents of a couple stew pots and three pitchers of ale. If there has been an intruder alert or the tower guards have been mobilized for any other reason, this mess is empty

The old hound is (AC 7; MV 15 "; HD 1 + 1; hp 6; #AT 1; D 1-4; AL N). His name is Bo. Far too old to be much of a threat, Bo will, in most situations, simply watch the action. He is, however, devoted to Dewey, and attacks if the simple-minded serving man is threatened in his presence. Bo also fights in self-defense.

13. Guards' Ale Room

> Four small, square tables, each with two chairs, surround the spiral staircase in the center of this chamber. There is a deck of playing cards on each table. A large keg with a padlocked spout is chained to an iron cradle set in the south wall.

If no alarm has been sounded and the guards have not been mobilized, two guards can be found relaxing in this room. Though fully armored, they are not armed. The pad locked keg holds ale. Only the captain (16) has the key.

The spiral staircase leads up to room 19 and down to room 6.

14. Forge and Repair Shop

> A large iron forge, now cold, is built into the center of the south wall. There are several work benches against the north wall. Each is covered with dozens of weapons--bows, spears, swords, and axes--all in varying states of disrepair. Two heavy leather blacksmith's aprons hang from hooks in the south wall nest to the forge. A large bellows, a shovel, and a pair of long iron stokers hang from spike set in the south wall east of the forge.

East of the forge, at the base of the south wall, is a secret compartment hidden behind a loose stone. Tucked inside is a long case containing an ancient *composite short bow +1*. Long hidden in its moisture-proof case of lacquered wood, the bow is the private project of a long-dead craftsman once employed at the tower.

15. Captain's Tower Room

> Two leashed hunting dogs are asleep on corn mats near the south wall. As you enter, they awaken and growl. On a table near the east wall is a double cage containing a pair of hunting hawks. A spiral staircase dominates the center of the room.

The dogs are (AC 6; MV 12"; HD 2 + 2; hp 13, 16; #AT 1; D 2-8; AL N). They have been trained not to attack humans, even if unleashed. However, their growling has a 60% chance of alerting the occupant of room 16 (if present). The hunting hawks are (AC 7; MV 24"; HD 1+1; hp 6, 7; #AT 3; D1-4/1-4/1-6; AL N). Only the captain can handle the hawks, and if released, they attack all those in the room except for him.

The spiral staircase leads up to room 20 and down to room 5.

16. Captain's Chamber
The door to this room is locked.

> A wide, comfortable-looking bed is set against the west wall. Beside it, resting on a tiled night table, is a small chest. A tall clothes cabinet stands against the east wall. Beside the cabinet is a small writing table with one chair. A decanter and one glass occupy the table.

There is a 60% chance that the captain is in his room (day or night) unless the tower is mobilized for battle. At night, the captain is AC 10 (sleeping). Otherwise he a (AC 3; MV 9"; F5, hp 44; #AT 1; D 1-8 (sword); AL LE). He wears plate mail armor under a gold-trimmed, gray tunic emblazoned with Edrin's black raven device. He carries 1-20 gp in a belt pouch together with a set of keys: one to his own room, one to the storeroom (9), and one to the padlock on the ale keg in the guards' mess (l3). The captain investigates any disturbances in any general alarm or large-scale melee.

The locked chest holds a sack of 200 pp and a small box that contains a gold necklace (100 gp).

The back wall of the locked clothes cabinet is fitted out with a weapons rack containing a heavy crossbow and a quiver of 10 bolts, a lance, a spear, and a shield decorated with Edrin's black raven device. Four shirts and tunics also bearing the black raven hang from a dowel set high in the cabinet. At the cabinet's base is a small locked chest holding assorted papers and service orders. One paper empowers the captain to take command of the garrison at Capel Tower. The

order is signed by Lord Edrin and sealed with the black raven symbol.

The decanter on the writing table holds one pint of fine quality brandy.

Capel Tower: Level III

17. Assassin's Chamber

> A large bed rests against the east wall of this tower chamber. Against the south wall is a three-foot high, glass-doored cabinet. Atop the cabinet is a small chest. Against the north wall is a desk and chair. An open footlocker a positioned between the desk and bed.

The door is bolted from inside: it is 40 hp. Any attempt to open it alerts the room's occu-pant, and actually opening the door by any means causes him to trigger two crossbow traps which fire at the doorway. The first two characters crossing the threshold are automati-cally hit; each takes 1-6 points of damage from the bolts and must save vs. poison to avoid the deadly effects of the poison smeared on the bolt rips. Failure to save results in the victim's death within 10 rounds unless remedial action (*neutralize poison*, *slow poison*) is taken.

The crossbow traps are located under the bed and angled up to the doorway. Two fine threads attached to the triggers lead out to the side of the bed so that anyone lying on it can trigger both crossbows by pulling the threads.

The discovery of the threads should be a clue to the characters that the crossbows have been manually fired.

The occupant of the chamber is currently invisible. He is Mendal Secord, an assassin and Lord Edrin's chief henchman in Andevar: (AC 1; MV 12"; A6; hp 31; #AT 1; D by weapon; SA poisoned weapons; AL LE; S 15, I 17, W 13, D 17, C 13, Ch 13). He wears *bracers of defense AC 5*, a *cloak of protection +1*, and a *ring of invisibility* (actually a *ring of spell storing* with five *invisibility* spells). Secord generally uses a poisoned *dagger +2* and a short sword.

In this situation, Secord has become invisible in order to escape from the chamber. His primary objective, and one which overrides ail other concerns, is the assassination of Prince Edmund. In an instant, he has determined that the party of intruders is too formidable to deal with and that attempting to do so would needlessly delay his getting to Edmund. Secord does not interfere with the party's search and presumed looting of his chamber. Rather, he remains invisible and retires to the tower halls to observe the characters while they remain in the structure. When they leave, Secord tries to follow them unobserved until they reach Griffon Castle.

When following the group, Secord assumes the guise of an old beggar, a ruse which he tries to keep up even if accosted and questioned by the party. If pressed, he uses his ring to escape again. See "Ending the Adventure" for more information on Mendal Secord.

The glass-doored cabinet holds assorted chemicals and substances used for making poisons. There are two small vials in the cabinet that contain a poisonous resin for tipping weapons.

The chest on top of the cabinet is locked. The key to the lock is strung on a cord around Secord's neck. Any attempt to open it without the key releases a charge of dust of sneezing and choking. Anyone within a 10-foot radius of the chest must save vs. poison or die immediately. Those who save are disabled by choking for 5-20 rounds.

The interior of the chest is lined with black velveteen. Pillowed inside it is a large, white chamois bag, tied at the top with a purple silken cord. Inside the bag is a solid gold, ruby-encrusted scepter and a gold and silver ball, eight inches in diameter, that bears a crown image over a ruby-studded cross of Dunador. These items are the royal seal and scepter of Dunador. Although they are in one sense priceless, if sold on the black market, each item brings 6,000 gp. All the characters recognize the seal and scepter.

Lifting a flap of the chest's velveteen lining raises a false bottom, revealing a small space in which the characters find a sack holding 1,000 gp.

The single drawer in the desk is locked. Inside, hidden behind a false panel at the rear, is a small metal box containing two bottles. One bottle holds a potion of levitation; the other holds a potion of gaseous form. The writing materials on top of the desk are ordinary.

The open footlocker holds a cape similar to those commonly worn by local brigands, a leather satchel containing six throwing daggers, and a small wooden box containing 10 poison-tipped crossbow bolts.

18. Northwest Turret

> Two large traveling trunks sit against the north wall of this cahmber. A spiral stair-case leads to a trapdoor above.

One chest holds 10 dark hooded capes and 10 studded leather jerkins similar to those affected by many of the local brigands. The other chest contains studded leather arm braces and 10 pairs of heavy boots, also typical of brigand garb.

The spiral staircase leads down to room 11 and up to the open parapet atop the tower. The trap door is not secured.

19. Southwest Turret

> The southwestern are of this room's wall contains an iron rack holding a score of long, spiked poles with a y-shaped head at one end. A small fireplace is set into the west wall. Next to it is a small table with a flask and six clay cups resting on top. A spiral staircase leads to a trapdoor above.

The poles are used to repel ladder assaults on the tower. The spiral staircase leads down to room 13 and up to the open parapet atop the tower. The trap door is not secured.

20. Southeast Turret

> A huge cauldron hangs from a spit over a large firepit in the south wall. There is a large pile of dry cord wood on the floor on either side of the pit. A pair of deep, iron ladies rest against one of the wood piles Spaced evenly along the walls of the cham-ber are eight wide barrels. A spiral staircase leads to a trap door above.

The barrels contain flammable oil which, when heated in the cauldron, is used for defense. The boiling oil is dispensed by means of the ladies into the dozens of wood-handled iron buckets which hang from hooks in the walls of the parapets. The tower's defenders then hurl the contents of the buckets at those trying to scale the walls.

As the parry moves north to the River Laine, they reach a messy limestone span known to the locals as Barbarian's Bridge. A sign proclaiming this fact to one and all is nailed to an elm tree near the southern entrance to the span. The bridge is 200 feet long and 15 feet wide. Its three stone piles are set deep in the river bed and linked by carefully joined stone arches capable of bearing even the heaviest traffic. Below the bridge surface, the white water of the Laine, sometimes as much as 30 feet deep tears angrily at the impervious stone.

Barbarian's Bridge

As the group begins to cross the bridge, they are surprised by the appearance from a nearby copse of trees of a dark rider on a black horse. He is accompanied by four other riders wearing dark brown cloaks. The dark rider is Kirkroy, the Duke of Andevar's champion (AC 3; MV 9"/18"; F6; hp 48; #AT 1; D 2-9 (*long sword +1*), 3-8 (*lance +1*); AL LE). He wears a plain, black tunic over splint armor and carries a small jousting shield. At his belt is a small pouch containing 3-60 gp and a jew-elled dagger worth 50 gp. Around his neck he wears a gold medallion engraved with Aimar's

golden lion insignia (50 gp).

Kirkroy rides a medium war horse (AC 7; MV 18"; HD 2 + 2; hp 17; #AT 3;D 1-6/1-6/1-3; S L; AL N).

Kirkroy's companions are (AC 4; MV 12"1 18"; F4; hp 24, 26. 29, 34; #AT 1; D 2-5 (heavy crossbow), 1-6 (short sword); AL LE). The heavy crossbows can be fired only once every two rounds. They ride medium horses (AC 7; MV 18"; HD 2 + 2; hp 12, 13, 14, 16; #AT 3; D 1-6/1-6/1-3; AL N). Beneath their brown capes, these riders wear blue tunics emblazoned with Aimar's golden lion device over fine chainmail.

Kirkroy and his men have been placed at the bridge by the Duke in order to cover Aimar's move to his new base of operations ar Griffon Castle.

As soon as the party begins to cross the bridge. Kirkroy rides out of the woods and gallops up to the center span where he awaits the party. Upon meeting the characters on the bridge, he tells them that it is impossible for them to cross. He does not tell them why. If they insist on trying to cross, Kirkroy challenges one of the party's fighters to single combat with horse and lance. He proposes that the winner and his parry may proceed as they will; the loser must withdraw.

Naturally, Kirkroy and his men have no intention of honoring any such agreement. His men attack as soon as the joust is over, regardless of the result. If the characters do not agree to Kirkroy's terms or leave, he and his men attack immediately.

Running the Joust

* Only combatants are allowed on the bridge.
* Only one attack is allowed for each mounted pass. Make a normal initiative roll to hit first.
* On a roll of a natural 20 to hit, an opponent must save vs. poison or be knocked off his or her mount.
* A mounted combatant has a + 2 chance to hit an opponent on foot.
* A mounted opponent has a + 2 chance to hit a mounted opponent's horse with sword, mace, flail, or other small weapon.
* On a roll of a natural 1 to hit, a combatant's lance breaks on impact. The fighter may get another lance if his seconds provide them at their end of the bridge.
* A mounted combatant using a sword, mace, flail, or other small weapon can't hit a mounted combatant using a lance.
* Combat continues, mounted or on foot, until a clear winner emerges.
* You must establish statistics for the player character's horse.

Ultimately, Kirkroy and his men neither give nor accept a quarter. If captured through enterprising means, they refuse to give information upon pain of death. An *ESP* spell, however, reveals that the prince is at Griffon Castle.

A well-trodden path runs west along the River Laine from the north side of the bridge. Clearly visible in the mud of the track are the recent imprints of horse hooves. Two miles from the bridge, the path reaches a thatch-roofed cottage perched along a low bank beside the Laine. The splintered wreck of a small boat is tied up to a pier near the front of the cottage. The front door of the dwelling is closed, but not locked.

The interior of the dwelling is a single 30-foot by 30-foot room. Its air is thick with ani-mal smells, and there are dozens of furs and skins nailed to the walls or strewn about the floor as rugs. In places, these have been torn from their hooks or kicked up from the floor as if in a scuffle. Many of them have been torn or slashed. In one corner of the cottage are the masked remains of a bed and a chest. Torn clothing and broken tools and cooking utensils are scattered everywhere in a way that suggests deliberate vandalism.

Except for Eli's hidden treasure trove of 75 gp (hidden in a box in a cubbyhole under one of the rafters in the north wall), nothing in the cottage, including the many animal pelts, has escaped damage. A careful inspection of the floor reveals a pool of congealed blood to the right of the door. Of Eli, however, there is no trace.

The solution to this riddle is, of course, that Eli was an eyewitness to the passage of the duke and his prisoner along the path from Barbarian's Bridge toward Griffon Castle. Not wishing to leave any embarrassing clues behind, Aimar ordered Kirkroy to take a squad of men to the cottage and dispense with the old hunter in such a way as to make the murder look like the work of brigands. After savagely attacking the aged Eli and ravaging the cottage, Kirkroy and his men left their victim for dead and rode on to take up their guard at the bridge. But Kirkroy did not count on Eli's good standing with the forest community. Once the attackers left, wood spirits arrived at the cottage, took care of Eli's wounds, and carried him off to heal in a secret forest glen far north of the river.

One of the sprites, a bold youngster named Toughnut. stayed near the cottage to keep an eve on the place. This tiny sprite is (AC 6; MV 9"/18"; HD 1; hp 6; #AT 1; D 1-3 (bow), 1-4 (sword); S 2'; AL NG). Toughnut, currently invisible, is now hiding just east of the cottage's front door.

Using his abilities, Toughnut determines the characters' alignments as soon as they arrive, but he will still be unsure of why they are in the cottage, and so, will bide his time. If Eli's treasure is taken, Toughnut fires a warning arrow dangerously close to the head of whomever has plundered the trove. Toughnut then imitates Eli's booming voice, saying, "Thieves and robbers! Have you no shame that you would steal the few pathetic coins of a poor old man!"

If the characters take the hint and give up Eli's treasure, Toughnut is better disposed toward them. If they refuse to give up the treasure, he makes its surrender a condition for giving the characters any information. After inquiring as to their purpose, the sprite, using his natural voice, explains Eli's fate and gives the following information:

> "The one you seek is gone. Only a few days ago, the young prince was taken west by the "golden lion." the one called Aimar. Eli knew of this. He saw. He told us that they could only be going to a place that he called 'the Griffon.' Eli was troubled by this. but the black ones came before he could do aught but tell us of his worry. We know nothing of the 'Griffon'; we do not travel much. But this we can tell you just as it was told us bv Eli. It is in the west, this place. Down the river over many of your miles. The waters of this river flow west. Follow them by the river's side, if you will. Or, if you be sailors, there is another way. Hidden in the trees by the river is another boat. Take it and be on your way. This I think that Eli would want."

So saying, the sprite retires to the woods. The other boat is hidden in the brush, 100 feet west of the cottage. It is a flat bottom scow. 18 feet long and 8 feet wide, and has a sail and a rudder. Even if the player characters are nor accomplished sailors, the river's current carries them to Griffon Castle. They only have to steer with the rudder and use the oars to slow their vessel. The boat is roomy enough for the party and all their gear, but their horses must be tethered and left by the river. If the players decide to float down the river, the voyage is without incident.

If the party takes the north riverside track, make the usual wandering monster checks.

Griffon Castle

Griffon Castle is a secret stronghold set back about 50 feet from the north bank of the River Laine and surrounded by a dense wood. Few even know that it still exists. Years ago, the Duke took the isolated castle from a robber baron who refused to swear fealty and mend his ways. Though the castle was ruined in the fighting, Aimar has, over the years (and especially since forming his alliance with Edrin), labored patiently and in secret to pur it back into repair. Since so few are aware of Aimar's secret project, the site makes an ideal hiding place for the captured prince.

Apart from the retainers, servants, sundry "pets," and the duke, the castle is garrisoned by 20 men-at-arms. All these human fighters wear scale mail armor and black-plumed helms. Each is equipped with a crossbow, a long sword, and a shield. When using their crossbows they are AC 5. None of this equipment bears any insignia. The Griffon Castle Roster indicates the guards who are presently in the castle.

Position these men as follows: at any time, day or night, there are 16 guards on duty; four others are asleep in barracks room 8. Seven of the 16 guards on duty are stationed in the towers, one guard atop each of the seven open-air turrets. Each open turret is equipped with a heavy crossbow (1 shot/2 rounds, D 2-5) that hangs from a hook driven into one of the turret's merlons. The other nine guards are positioned as indicated in the following room descriptions.

Currently the entire garrison is on alert; the discovery of any intrusion causes the mobilization of the captain and all the guards except those in room 20.

Entry to Griffon Castle

The party can enter the castle in two ways:

1. By finding the traitor's gate (next to room 13) after a covert search of the outside wall. Such a search is not possible in daylight in view of the towers above.

2. By an open (and very foolhardy) attempt to assault the walls or main gates. In the event of an open attempt, mobilize all the occupants of Griffon Castle and organize an effective defense. The tops of seven of the eight towers are equipped with bells for use in sounding an alarm.

Griffon Castle: Ground Level

1. Southwest Gatehouse

As befits a border stronghold. Griffon Castle is blessed with an extremely strong gate, complete with portcullis. The latter is always down, and no entry is permitted. A winch for raising the portcullis is located in gatehouse 1. The room is bare except for a barrel of water and twelve drinking mugs hanging from hooks driven into the wall beside it. The walls are breached here and there by narrow arrow slits.

2. Southeast Gatehouse

There a a guard on duty in gatehouse 2. Thanks to the arrow slits in the gatehouse, he has an excellent view of the exterior of the gate. The guardsman is charged under penalty of death with immediately reporting to the captain in room 15 any attempt to approach the gate. He is extremely vigilant. Located in this room is a release mechanism for the castle's outer door.

Griffon Castle Roster

Class/Level	AL	Gear	Combat Bonus	AC	hp
F2	LN	20 sp, dagger	+1 with sword	5/6	14
F3	LE	10 gp, ring (1 gp)	+1 with X-bow	5/6	21
F4	LE	6 pp, 11 sp		5/6	39
F1	LN	1 gp, 4 sp		5/6	8
F2	LN	2 gp, dagger		5/6	12
F5	LE	40 sp, 3 gp	+1 with X-bow	5/6	42
F4	LN	22 sp, 3 ep		5/6	29
F3	LN	50 sp	+1 with X-bow	5/6	25
F2	LN	10 ep, ring (4 sp)		5/6	13
F3	LN	5 gp	+1 with X-bow	5/6	29
F3	LE	3 rubies (40 gp)	+1 with sword	5/6	22
F4	LN	17 sp, 30 cp		5/6	22
F3	LN	10 gp	+1 with X-bow	5/6	24
F4	LN	5 sp		5/6	29
F2	LE	5 cp, dagger		5/6	12
F3	LN	10 sp		5/6	17
F2	LN	11 gp		5/6	14
F4	LE	15 gp	+1 with X-bow	5/6	33
F2	LN	9 cp	+1 with sword	5/6	15
F3	LN	30 sp, 10 gp		5/6	24

3. Tower Chamber

> A spiral staircase near the south wall leads to another chamber above. There are two large barrels near the east wall. Beside the door is a weapons rack holding four spears.

There is one guard on duty in this room. The barrels hold fresh water. the spiral stairs lead to room 17.

4. Tower Chamber

> A cask rests on a stained plank table near the west wall. A spiral stairccase near the south wall leads to an upper chamber.

One guard is stationed in this room. The case contains mead. The spiral stairs lead to room 19.

5. Great Hall

> There is an immense fireplace with a limestone mantle set into the west wall. A large tapestry hangs over the fireplace. The hangings depict an odd sort of creature, part bird and part animal. A long, heavy oak table flanked by two benches occupies the center of the room. Large carved and padded chairs are placed at the head and foot of the table. A second smaller tapestry with a golden lion boldly woven into its background of blue flowers hangs from the east wall.

Set into the wall behind the tapestry is a three-foot by two-foot wooden panel. The panel can be opened by pushing a stone pressure plate in the floor just below it.

A recess behind the panel holds a locked chest, the key to which hangs on a silken cord around Aimar's neck. Any attempt to open the chest without the key causes a toxic gas to be released; those within 10 feet must save vs. breath weapon or fall unconscious for 3 turns. The chest contains 20 gold plates, 20 gold goblets, and 20 gold cutlery sets worth a total of 1,000 gp.

6. Kitchen

> The kitchen is dominated by a big brick and tile oven set into the north wall. There is a rude wooden bin on either side of the stove. Shelves full of pots, pans, and sealed crocks line the other walls. Dried vegetables and herbs hang from the rafters. The air is heavy with the smell of sage.

One bin is full of onions; the other contains a collection of tuberous vegetables. The crocks contain a variety of pickled meats, fruits, and vegetables.

7. Storeroom

Piled high against the wall of this circular chamber are hundreds of small mealy bags. A dozen slabs of slated mutton hang from hooks in the ceiling. Three barrels occupy the center of the room. The room is roofed, floored, and panelled with tightly-joined walnut boards.

The mealy bags contain flour and grain. One barrel contains apples, one contains salt port, and the other holds iron rations.

8. Barracks

Twenty narrow beds line the walls of this hut. Quarrel quivers hang on books behind each bed.

Unless the alarm has been sounded, there are four guards asleep in this hut In this situation, guards are AC 10 and require 1 round to get their swords.

Under each bed is an oaken footlocker containing personal items such as spare boots, breeches, flasks of mead, and spare parts for crossbows (string, triggers, bolt heads, etc.). Each quiver on the wall holds 2-40 quarrels (light).

9. Tower Chamber

A spiral staircase near the north wall of this chamber leads to an upper level. Beside the staircase, set against the north wall, is a tall oaken cabinet. There are two big bar-rels near the west wall.

Unless the alarm has been sounded, there is one guard stationed in this room. The barrels hold fresh water. The locked cabinet contains a fine suit of chain mail (suitable for a human or half elf), a lance, a broadsword, and a shield. The spiral stairs lead to room 22.

10. Northwest Gatehouse

The north gate, like its twin to the south, is quite strong, having its own portcullis in addition to the gate itself. The former is always down, and no entry is permitted here, either. There is a guard on duty in gatehouse 10. Thanks to the arrow slits in its walls, he has an excellent view of the exterior of the gate. Like the guardsman at the south gate, he is charged under penalty of death with immediately reporting to the captain in room 15 any attempt to approach the gate. He, like his fellow at the south gate, is extremely vigilant. Located in this room is a door release mechanism for the castle's outer door.

11. Northeeast Gatehouse

Gatehouse 11 is empty except for the winch user to raise the portcullis.

12. Tower Chamber

Spiral stairs near the north wall lead to a chamber above. A tall oaken cabinet stands against the east wall.

Unless the alarm has been sounded, there is one guard on duty here. The cabinet is locked. It holds a weapons rack with brackets for 20 heavy crossbows. Seven of the weapons are missing. At the bottom of the cabinet are four open wooden boxes filled with heavy crossbow bolts.

The spiral stairs lead to room 24.

13. Stables and Traitor's Gate

Nine of the ten narrow stalls against the east wall are occupied by horses. The fifth stall from the north is vacant. A dozen big feed bags are stacked by the west wall. A pair of water buckets hang from the gate-post by each stall.

The nine horses are light war horses. A careful examination of the fifth stall reveals a hidden door set into its east wall. Just to the left of the door, one of the vertical boards pro-trudes slightly from the others in the stall's wall. Pulling the board so that it swings our on a spring-fed hinge opens the door. Characters have the normal chance of locating this door. Dwarves, elves, half elves, gnomes, and thieves gain an extra +1 if they are expressly looking for a secret door.

Behind the hidden door is a narrow passage running eastward four feet to a stone wall. In the wall is the outline of another door. This door is four feet high and three feet wide and has an iron ring handle. Turning the ring causes the door to open inward, giving access to the exterior of the castle.

14. Stables

Ten narrow stalls on the east wall hold 10 horses. There are two barrels and a stack of 30 to 40 feed bags against the west wall. Two large chests occupy the northwest corner of the stable

One chest contains 20 light horse saddles. The other contains 40 different bridles and reins. All 10 horses are light war hoses.

15. Captain's Office

A wide, but rather short, bed occupies the northeast corner of this chamber. At the foot of the bed is a big, iron-bound chest. Flush against the western part of the south wall is a plain writing desk. There is a trap door with a heavy iron ring visible in the floor in the southeast corner of the chamber.

If no alarm has been sounded. there is a 70% chance that the captain and one guard are in the room. If they are not present when the characters enter, roll 1d6 once every 10 rounds while the party is in the room. On a roll of 1-3, the captain and one guard return.

The captain of the guard is a nasty dwarf named Dram: AC 3. MV 9"; F6; hp 47; #AT 1; D 4-11 (axe 1-8 +3); saves at +1; AL LE. Dram wears plate armor and wields a two-handed axe. Hanging- from his belt are a dagger, an iron ring containing a set of keys to rooms 16 and 17 and the cabinet in room 12, and a pouch containing 10 gp.

The locked chest holds 300 gp and the captain's personal belongings.

Among the papers strewn across the desk is a pay roster for the 20 men-at-arms guarding the castle. A single unlocked drawer in the desk contains iron rations, an empty wineskin, and a flask of brandy. At the back of the drawer is a leather sack holding two gold neck braces (30 gp each) and a silver cross of Dunador (20 sp). These items are loot taken from the prisoners in the dungeon below.

The trap door lets onto a flight of steep stairs leading to the dungeon. A single door at the foot of the stairs is bolted from the outside. Behind the door, a 20-foot by 20-foot cell contains the bodies of four dead humans clad in the tattered remnants of pilgrim's robes. One of the men seems to have died as a result of one or more wounds. The others have died of thirst. The four were the Prince's companions on his pilgrimage.

16. Armory *(door locked)*

This semicircular chamber houses an excellent armory. Weapons racks set in the walls hold scores of spears, lances, pikes, guisarmes, and halberds. There are two large chests against the east wall, and a barrel set on either side of the door.

The wall racks hold 40 of each type of weapon. One chest holds 20 long bows, the other holds 500 arrows. The barrels hold poor quality inflammable oil.

Griffon Castle: Upper Level

Stairway access to this upper level is through the four round tower chambers. Spiral stairways from ground level chambers lead to open landings in the upper tower chambers. On the second level, the spiral stairs in 22, 19, and 17 continue upward, ending in trap doors in the ceilings that lead to parapets on the turrets above. Staircases in 18, 20, 23, and 25 also end in trap doors in the ceiling which give out on the wall parapets.

Undisguised movement along the open-air parapets, day or night, is certain to attract the attention of the guards on top of the seven turrets. At night, crouching low behind the merlons and moving as quietly as possible gives the characters a 70% chance of moving undetected from one tower to another. (Thieves have a 95% chance of accomplishing this feat.) If any character's movements are detected by a guard, there is a 50% chance that the guard sounds the alarm bell at his station. A percentage roll of 51 or higher means that the guard assumes the sound was insignificant and ignores it.

As previously noted, a general alarm mobilizes all castle occupants in an organized search for the intruders. (See encounter 26 for the special role of the griffon.)

17. Tower Chamber (Guardhouse)

> A spiral staircase near the south wall leads to a trap door in the ceiling. A table surrounded by four chairs occupies the center of the room. There is a small cask and four stoneware mugs on the table. Twenty spiked poles with y-shaped heads at one end are set in racks fixed to the walls. The east wall contains a fireplace of rough fieldstone.

This chamber is a way station for the guards mounting wall patrols. The cask holds a few quarts of cheap mead. The staircase leads down to room 3 and up to the parapet atop the turret.

18. Aimar's Sanctuary

The door to this room is locked.

> The walls of this well-appointed chamber are decorated with fine tapestries depicting heroic battles waged by noble knights against horn-helmed barbarians. The golden lion coat-of-arms is displayed prominently in all the hangings. In the middle of the west wall, there is an elaborate fireplace and hearth topped by a finely dressed stone mantle. An armchair, upholstered in bottle-green cut velvet place before the fire. An ornately-carved walnut desk and chair are positioned against the north wall. Against the east wall is a small glass-doored walnut bookcase.

Atop the mantle are a pair of black candles in gold candlesticks (40 gp each). An ornate set of fireplace tools stand in a small bin north of the hearth. The tool's handles are made of finely chased silver filigree (200 sp total).

The desk drawer holds writing parchment and a gold lion seal for marking letters and documents. Two quill pens and an ink well are placed on top of the desk.

The bookcase holds books on a variety of sorcerous subjects. Except for one plain book with no markings that is larger than the others, the books in the two-tiered bookcase are quite mundane. This one unusual book is located at the far right side of the top shelf. It is a *librum of gainful conjurations*. Because of his evil alignment, Aimar has never been able to read it.

Any magic user or illusionist of neutral alignment who reads the librum gains enough experience points to put him at the midpoint of the next higher level. A complete reading of the book requires a character's undivided attention for one full week. Any non-neutral magic user or illusionist reading even one line of the book sustains 5-20 points of damage and falls unconscious for the same number of turns. Any magic-using victims of the book must seek a cleric to atone in order to regain the ability to progress in experience. Without such atonement, the character gains no further experience points. Any non-magic user who peruses the book must save vs. spells to avoid insanity. Insane characters must receive a *remove curse* spell and rest for one month unless a cleric heals them.

The Secret Room

Located in the southern part of the room, behind a tapestry near the east wall, is a hidden door. Sheathed in painted plaster, it can hardly be distinguished from the stonework in the walls. The door is opened by pressing a pressure plate in the floor next to it. Behind the hidden door is a three-sided recess occupied by a large, locked chest containing 2,000 gp, 5,000 sp, and 500 pp. Also inside the chest is a small wooden box containing a necklace set with a single sparkling gem -- a *luckstone*. It gives its wearer +1 on saving throws and throws to avoid traps and pitfalls; however, the "luck" doesn't apply to hit and damage rolls. The stone does not work for characters of evil alignment.

The librum, the luckstone, and the treasure within this secret room were all wrested from the previous lord of Griffon Castle.

19. Tower Chamber

> A spiral staircase near the southern wall leads to a trap door in the ceiling. The western part of the chamber is taken up by a fire pit, over which hangs an iron cauldron. There are four barrels grouped in the northeast corner.

The cauldron is used to boil the oil contained in the barrels. The hot oil is then dumped down the castle's battlements onto the heads of its attackers.

The spiral staircase leads down to room 4 and up to the parapet atop the turret.

20. West Tower Antechamber

> A staircase leads to a trap door in the ceiling of the western part of this semicircular chamber. Set in the east wall of the chamber is a heavy door, flanked on either side by a guard in scale mail, equipped with a sword and shield.

The pair of guards is assigned to secure the prisoner in room 21. They have strict orders not to leave their posts for any reason. If a melee breaks out, one of the guards tries to get up the stair to sound the alarm bell on the open parapets of the turret.

21. Prison Chamber

This chamber door is bolted from outside.

> A figure dressed in a filthy pilgrim's robe lies on a small cot in the northeast corner of this sparsely-furnished chamber. There is a fireplace in the middle of the east wall. A simple writing desk and chair occupy the south wall.

The reclining figure is Prince Edmund. Gaunt and haggard from his recent ordeal, the royal heir is barely conscious. The party can confirm the prince's identity by comparing his features to those in the portrait of him that they carry. A *cure light wounds* spell or an application of healing potion or ointment gets the prince on his feet, but he won't be able to fight for some days. He is, however, able to keep up with the group during travel. The prince is AC 10; MV 9"; F2; hp 1(13); no weapons, AL LG. When discovered, Edmund has only 1 hp remaining.

As soon as he is on his feet and aware of his surroundings, the prince expresses the following concerns and comments in whatever order seems appropriate:

"Who are you! Why are you here! Were you sent by my father!"

"Where are my loyal comrades! Are they safe! Please tell me. I bid you."

"But why was I kidnapped! And why brought here!"

"The Royal Council must know of what has happened here. Aimar is a traitor; of that there is no doubt. But the poison goes further. I am sure. Perhaps all the way to my Uncle Edrin, who has long coveted the throne."

"Stand a moment, friends. Let me get my legs under me. It has been such a strange time, alone here in the dark. And always that screeching in my ear. Like some great bird trying to speak its hate of men. A dream, perhaps, but even now my head is filled with that terrible sound."

Edmund's single burning desire. at the moment, is to return to Dunthrane as soon as possible. But, being young, inexperienced. and in a weakened state, he places his fate entirely in the hands of the characters, deferring to their decisions as to strategy and tactics. If his opinion is solicited, Edmund sides with characters who are of good alignment.

22. Tower Chamber

A spiral staircase near the northern wall of this room leads to a trap door in the ceiling. The south and east walls are lined with weapons racks containing spiked poles. A fireplace is set into the west wall.

The stairs lead down to room 9 and up to the parapet atop the turret.

23. Aimar's Bedroom *(door locked)*

A large four poster bed takes up the entire southeast corner of the room. A fireplace is set into the middle of the east wall. Above the fireplace are shelves containing a lamp, an hourglass, a set of tongs, and an inverted funnel. In the southeast corner stands a tall walnut wall cabinet. Fine tapestries adorn all of the chamber's walls.

Beneath the bed is a footlocker filled with boors, spurs, leg braces and leggings. Somewhere in this tangle of leather goods is a leather sack containing a pair of *bracers of defense AC6*.

The locked wall cabinet holds a dozen pair of silk and velvet pantaloons with matching doublers and a pair of royal blue tunics. The tunics are embroidered with the golden lion device. A small chest at the bottom of the cabinet contains 100 gp, 200 sp, and a rolled-up parchment encircled by a black ribbon. The parchment is a letter from Lord Edrin to the Duke of Andevar exhorting the latter to "deal with our friend, the pilgrim." This is a coded reference to the kidnapping and killing of Prince Edmund.

Hidden in the bottom hem of the base of the tapestry on the south wall is a 14-inch metal tube. Inside the tube is a w*and of magic missiles* with 12 charges. This item functions up to twice per round to deliver a 2-5 hp missile. Each missile needs three segments to fire and uses one charge.

24. Tower Chamber

Four narrow beds crowd the east wall of this room. A spouted barrel rests against the north wall.

There are no spiral stairs in this room, just a hole leading down to the stairway below. At any one rime, one to four servants (AC10, MV 9"; hp 6 each; #AT nil; AL N) are asleep here. Greatly fearing the duke's wrath, the servants will do nothing to help the party. If threatened, they will feign ignorance about the castle and all its occupants.

Beneath the beds, the servants have hidden their few paltry possessions (1-20 cp per servant).

25. East Tower Antechamber

A staircase near the eastern wall of this semicircular room leads to a trap door in the ceiling. The room, itself, is bare. A rather large, brutish-looking individual stands before a carved door in the west wall.

The room's occupant is Aimar's bodyguard, a huge half-orc named Lom (AC3; MV9"; F6; hp 46; #AT 1; D1-10 (two-handed sword); S M; AL LE). Lom wears plate armor and a spiked helm. Stuck in his belt are a dagger and a footman's flail. Around his neck is a cord from which is suspended a pouch holding 1-10 pp and 2-20 gp. Lom fights to the death to defend Aimar.

Any disturbances in this room attracts the attention of Aimar, who emerges from room 21, within three rounds of hearing the sound of fighting.

26. Aimar's Quarters

A large fireplace and mantle dominate the west wall of this chamber. There are three small statuettes atop the mantle. A low table, flanked by a pair of carved, leather-upholstered chairs, is positioned in front of the fire. A crystal decanter filled with an amber liquid and two crystal goblets are arranged on the table. Against the north wall is a large bed covered in heavy furs. A table topped by a small chest sits against the south wall. In the southwest corner of the room, two horizontal bars hang from chains bolted to the ceiling.

If Aimar did not enter the melee in room 25, he is in this room. The Duke of Andevar is a fighter/magic user (AC1; MV 12"; F/MU 6/5; hp 40; #AT 1; D 3-10(sword + 2); AL LE; S 15, 1 17, W 13, D 16, C 16, Ch 14). He wears a black tunic embroidered with the golden lion device, *bracers of defense AC 5*, and a *ring of protection +1* (saves at +1). His Dexterity gives his two pluses on his armor class. In this situation. Aimar may use *magic missile* (twice), *shocking grasp*, *ray of enfeeblement*, and, in desperation, a *fireball*. If Aimar uses the fireball while in room 25, he retreats to room 21, (or to the open parapets) and launches the 5d6 fireball into room 25. Aimar will not use the fireball if him or his companion, Riannon, are uninjured.

Aimar has two pet blood hawks who follow him to the attack. The blood hawks are (AC 1; MV 12"/24"; HD 1+1; hp 7,7; #AT 3; D 1-4/1-4/1-6. AL N). The horizontal bars in room 26 are perches for these birds.

As suggested by the two goblets. another person also occupies Aimar's quarters -- his mistress, Riannon. A half-elf magic user/thief, Riannon is (AC 7; MV 12"; MU/T 3/4; hp 17; #AT 2; D 2-5/2-5 (dagger +1); AL CE). On a successful backstab, Riannon does double damage. She wears studded leather armor. Riannon has the use of three memorized spells: *sleep*, *feather fall*, and *invisibility*.

Though quite fond of the duke's wealth and power, beautiful Riannon is too much the adventuress to risk her life for Aimar. Her main goal is survival, and if Aimar is beaten and she is captured, she will quickly surrender and offer to join the party. In this situation. Riannon will admit to being a thief, but will conceal her magic-user skills. She may even attempt to persuade the party that Aimar held her against her wishes, though Prince Edmund will maintain just the opposite. If the characters try to win Riannon's trust, her manner will soften and she will start to behave in a friendly manner, even going so far as to show them Aimar's treasure room (18).

However, once outside the east tower chamber, Riannon will use a shrill, birdlike call to summon the griffon from on top of the northeast tower (24). To remove herself from the action once the griffon arrives, she uses feather fall from the wall, turns invisible and flees to the nearby woods to watch the fun. Her hope is, of course, that if the griffon destroys the party then she can return and make off with all of Aimar's treasure. If the situation becomes life-threatening to Riannon, she will abandon this plan and quit the area entirely.

The chest on the table in room 26 holds 1,000 gp worth of precious gems and jewelry, a gift from Aimar to Riannon. The three statuettes on the mantle are lions; one is gold and worth 100 gp; one is silver and worth 100 sp; the third is bronze. The bronze lion is hollow and contains a small leather pouch inside of which the characters will find a ruby worth 200 gp.

The wall cabinet contains a suit of leather armor, a cloak and a bag holding a set of thieves' tools. On the floor of the cabinet, hidden under an old tunic is Riannon's spell book.

The Griffon

If the griffon (AC 3; MV 12"/30 "; HD 7; hp 44; #AT 3; D 1-4/1-4/2-16; S L; AL N) does not attack at Riannon's summons, it is attracted by the sound and smell of the characters' horses as they try to leave the castle, and attacks at that time. The events inside the castle having disrupted the griffon's regular feeding schedule, the beast is now hungry enough to do its own hunting. It attacks with determination in an effort to get at the party's horses, but prefers a riderless mount at all times. If it can isolate a horse, it breaks off its attack and starts to feast; if interrupted in its feast, it fights to the death. If the characters don't use horses to leave the castle and it is not summoned by Riannon, the griffon does not appear.

With the defeat of Aimar and the freeing of Prince Edmund, the evil designs of the Duke of Andevar have been thwarted. It remains, however, for the party to make its way safely back to Dunthrane. They may retrace the way they came through Capel Tower and Montinelle, or they may ride south from Griffon Castle and then through Noren's Wood. In either case, they must still reckon with the forces of Lord Edrin.

Lord Edrin's Forces

Lord Edrin's remaining forces include two groups of horsemen, one group of infantry, and the assassin, Mendal Secord. By this time, Lord Edrin, having had no news of the fate of the prince, has sent most of his own men to Andevar to make sure chat Edmund does not turn up again.

Ironically, as regent of Dunador, Edrin has also been forced to send some of his troops to restore and guard Fontenmere Abbey, which was so recently sacked by a group of his men disguised as brigands. Edrin's forces in Andevar include:

Group 1

8 horsemen: AC 6; MV 12"/24"; F3; hp 20 each; #AT 1; D 1-6 with lance; AL LN

1 captain: AC 4; MV 12"/24"; F4 ; hp 32; #AT 1; D 1-8 with sword; AL LE

9 light horses: AC 7; MV 24"; HD 2; hp 15 each; #AT 0; AL N

All the horsemen wear gray tunics emblazoned with the black raven device. The troopers wear scale armor, but have no shields. They carry swords at their sides. Each also carries 1-20 sp. The captain wears chain armor under a gold-trimmed gray tunic. He carries a shield, a sword, and 2-40 gp.

The party encounters this group patrolling the road from the Three Leathers Inn through Montinelle to Capel Tower. They know of the events at Capel Tower and are aware of the party's presence in the region. Their express purpose is to find and kill Edmund. The most likely spot for an encounter with these troops is at the Drake & Castle Inn.

Group 2

This group is identical to the first group except that there are only five horsemen (instead of eight) and their captain. On a roll of 1 or 2 on 1d6, this group is encountered patrolling the roads from the Three Feathers Inn past Fontenmere Abbey and thence northwest as far as the secret path through Noren's Wood. It will never be encountered on the secret path or inside Noren's Wood. If the party does not encounter this patrol further north, then it does meet the patrol at the Three Feathers Inn.

Group 3

10 foot soldiers: AC 5; MV 3"; F3; hp 18 each; #AT 1; D 1-6 with spear; AL LN

1 captain: AC 4; MV 3"; F4; hp 23; #AT 1; D 1-8 with sword; AL LE

The infantrymen making up this party are dressed in gray tunics emblazoned with the black raven device. Beneath their tunics they wear scale armor. Each is armed with a sword and spear and carries a shield. Each has 1-20 sp on his person. There are two horses left at Fontenmere and two of the fighters pursue the group on horseback if such action is appropriate to the encounter.

In the improbable event that the group tries to return the royal seal and scepter to Fontenmere, the captain tries to take them into his custody.

Edrin's men have cleaned up the damage inflicted on the abbey by the brigands who sacked it. Two guards are now posted outside the abbey, one at the north door and one at the south door. The captain and the rest of his troop are inside. The captain has set up a makeshift office in room 3.

The troop's ostensible purpose is to restore and guard the abbey. However, the captain has secret orders to kill Prince Edmund if he should fall into the soldiers' hands. If the prince is recognized, the captain orders his men to attack and fight to the death. If the melee goes against Edrin's men, the captain sends one of the men to ride for reinforcements. If Edmund is captured, the captain kills him.

Mendal Secord, the Assassin

Mendal Secord has shadowed the party all the way from Capel Tower to Griffon Castle, moving along the river track on horseback. Having thus discovered Duke Aimar's secret stronghold, Secord has established himself in a wooded hiding place and waited for events to unfold. If he sees the party leave the castle without the prince, he contents himself with trailing it south. If the prince is with the party, however, Secord prepares to move against his royal victim as rapidly as possible, preferably before the party reaches any of the main roads of Andevar.

Secord has already laid a tentative plan for the assassination. Using his *ring of invisibility* and his skill as an assassin, he tries to get ahead of the party and ambush the prince in some convenient wooded area, dropping onto Edmund from a tree. If this plan can't be concluded successfully, he tries to attack the prince when the party makes camp for the night.

Regardless of which plan he uses, Secord

makes a surprise attack from the rear. If he leaps at the prince in ambush, he does not have the benefit of his + 4 to hit; however, he does have a 30 percent chance of causing triple damage with his *dagger +2* through two attacks in the same round. As soon as he attacks, the assassin slips off his ring and becomes visible. If hit, the prince must save vs. poison or die within 10 rounds, unless remedial measures are taken to bind his wounds and deal with the poison from Secord's dagger blade. Secord sustains his attack until the prince is hit once.

If Secord attacks the prince while the group camps for the night, he has a + 4 bonus to hit from the rear. However, he has a base chance of only 70 percent to get silent access to the prince. For every character on guard duty, Secord's chance to move silently is lessened by 15 percent. If Secord fails to move silently, tell the characters on guard that they hear a rustling in the bushes or a snapping twig. As in the first scenario, Secord becomes visible as soon as he attacks.

To recap, Mendal Secord is human (AC 1; MV 12"; A6; hp 31; #AT 2; D 3-6, 3-6 with *dagger +2*; SA poison; AL LE). He wears *bracers of defense AC 5*, a *cloak of protection*, and a *ring of invisibility* with no more than four charges left. He carries a short sword and a purse containing 1-20 gp and 1-10 pp.

After attacking Edmund. Secord tries to escape on foot and reach his horse, which is tethered within 200 feet of the attack site. If he is overtaken, Secord becomes invisible if his ring still contains at least one charge. Otherwise, he fights to the death.

If he escapes, the assassin returns to Dunthrane, believing that he has killed the prince. There is a 60 percent chance that Secord falls prey to the worgs if he travels through Noren's Wood on his way back to Dunthrane.

The Secret Path

A few miles west of Griffon Castle and in plain sight of it is a narrow bridge over the Laine River. The bridge is part of an old road, now fallen into disuse, that cuts through this northwestern parr of the province. Point out to the party that this track seems considerably less traveled than other roads in Andevar. Ten miles south of the river, the party comes to a huge boulder just east of the road. At this point, the main road turns west. Behind this rock, and barely distinguishable amid the long grass that overgrows it, is a narrow path weaving slightly southeast. The path is wide enough for one horse, allowing single-file passage only.

Noren's Wood

Noren's Wood is home to a band of 10 vicious worgs, each (AC 6, MV 18"; HD 4 + 4; hp 30, 26, 25, 23, 21, 20, 20, 19, 17, 16; #AT 1; D 2-8; S L. AL NE). Currently the worgs are hunting small, cute animals in the southwest portion of the woods. If Mendal Secord attacks Edmund in this forest, he does so near the northern entrance. Then, if the assassin escapes the party, he rides south through the wood. There is a 60 percent chance that he and the worgs meet near the southern end of the secret path, in which case Mendal Secord automatically becomes lunch. The party finds his incomplete mortal remains near the southern edge of the wood. His weapons and all magical items except the *ring of spell storing* are gone.

For the last 15 miles of the party's journey through the wood, check twice to see if they, too, are attacked by worgs. An encounter occurs on a roll of 1 on 1d6.

Conclusion -- If Edmund is Alive

Once the party passes south of the Three Feathers Inn, it may automatically proceed to Dunthrane in safety. As the characters enter the fortified town, crowds gather around Edmund and the adventurers. Cries of joy and chants of "hail the king," fill the air.

When word of this event spreads to the castle grounds, Hollend's few retainers move quickly to disarm Lord Edrin's depleted forces. Throughout the town Edrin's black raven banners are replaced by the yellow banners of the Royal House of Dunthrane. At the castle gates. Hollend and the council greet Edmund with a trumpet fanfare.

After a day of rest, Prince Edmund and Hollend hold an audience with the party at which the adventurers learn that Lord Edrin is in irons and that Mendal Secord (if he returned to Dunthrane) has been charged with the murder of King Halfred. If Secord is dead, the parry hears that the late Secord was the king's assassin. Furthermore, a case is being made against Edrin for the murder of William Menote, Patriarch of Fontenmere. In the face of overwhelming evidence. it looks to Hollend like Edrin is well on his way to being shortened by a head.

At the end of the audience. the party learns that the young prince will be crowned king as soon as a new patriarch is elected for Fontenmere.

A grateful Edmund gives each character a reward of 2,000 gp and proclaims a week of celebration in their honor. Each surviving adventurer is also made an honorary citizen of Dunador and a new yearly holiday, to be called Liberation Day, is decreed in their honor. If any of the party died in the quest. Edmund asks the survivors to remain in Dunador to provide the bards with material for use in songs honoring their memories.

Of course, the party must return the royal seal and scepter of Dunador. Reward the party with an additional 6,000 experience points (divided equally) if they voluntarily return these treasured symbols.

Conclusion -- If Edmund is Dead

If the group bears Edmund's body back to Dunthrane, eliminate all fanfare and celebration from the previous scenario. In its place. terrible cries of anguish and wails of mourning fill the air as the dead prince is carried to the castle gates. Hollend meets the characters. Taking them aside, he asks about their mission and how it comes that Edmund is dead. When satisfied with the explanation, Hollend makes the following proposal.

> "This may be the darkest hour in the history of Dunador. Oh that evil should triumph in spite of all our efforts! A king, a patriarch, and now a prince, all dead at the hands of this evil lord. I fear now that we are, indeed, lost.
>
> "And yet, there may be one final chance to save the realm from this prince of evil. Edrin's forces are depleted. Some of his men are less than faithful. I believe that, thanks to you, he has but a handful of loyal men-at-arms at his side. If I go forth now and publicly charge him with the murder of his noble kinsmen, he must answer. As heir to the throne, he cannot be tried by the laws of man. But he must answer to our gods.
>
> "The way it is done is this: I can challenge him to champion combat, and before the people he would would have to accept the challenge. I know Edrin would not delegate this responsibility to a lesser man, for he is a knight well skilled in the fighting arts. Alas. for this task I am now far too old, and there are no others here who could unhorse the villain. None, that is, save one of you, perhaps. I have already asked much of you in this quest. but now I appeal to you once more. Will one of you take up arms again for truth, justice, and the people of Dunador! Though the foe be fearsome and the trial to the death, will one of you be our champion?"

If the characters refuse Hollend's appeal, he bids them a regretful farewell. The adventure is then over. The characters leave, however, in certain knowledge that Dunador is left to the mercy of the evil Lord Edrin. In keeping with

such an unchivalrous action, the churlish characters receive no reward of any sort (money, honors, or bonus experience points).

If, on the other hand, the characters accept Hollend's appeal, the king's advisor forces the issue with Lord Edrin. The Royal Council sends criers throughout Dunthrane to issue Hollend's challenge and charges. In a matter of hours, both charges and the challenge are echoed by hundreds of voices throughout Dunthrane.

In the face of overwhelming pressure, Lord Edrin accepts Hollend's challenge. The contest is set for the following day and takes the form of a joust to the death in the combat field next to Dunthrane Castle.

Choosing a Champion

It may be that there is one character who is the obvious champion. If not, you can help the players choose a champion by having them draw lots. After listing the appropriate fighter or fighter multi-class characters, have the eligible players draw pencils, cut straws, or cut toothpicks. The player who draws the shortest stick is the champion.

After the champion is chosen, Hollend and the council offer the character a lance, a suit of plate armor, and a medium war horse (AC 7; MV 18"; HD 2+2; hp 18; #AT 0; S L; AL N). The character may accept these things or refuse them. Hollend asks the character to bear the shield colors of Dunador (light blue Dunadorian cross on a field of canary yellow). Make a note of the character's adjustment in armor class.

Lord Edrin

Lord Edrin takes the field in black plate armor. His shield bears the black raven insignia against a field of light gray. A gold raven encircled by the silver crown of the regent of Dunador is fixed atop his black helmet. Lord Edrin is (AC 2; MV 12"/18"; F6; hp 44; #AT 1; D 2-7 with lance, 1-8 with sword; AL LE; S 15, I 16. W 12, D 14, C 16, CH 13). He rides a medium war horse (AC 7; MV 18"; HD 2+2; hp 17; #AT 3; D 1-6/1-6/1-3; S L; AL N). He carries a sheathed long sword at his side.

Rules for the Joust

Use the same jousting rules described for the Barbarian's Bridge encounter. Each combatant is allowed only two weapons in this contest; a lance and one other. The joust is to the death.

If the character dies at the hands of Lord Edrin, all other characters can leave Dunador in safety, taking the body of their fallen companion with them. But they leave without honors or reward.

If Lord Edrin is slain, a great cry of joy and exultation rises from the crowd. All the fanfare outlined earlier takes place. Despite their sorrow over Prince Edmund's death, the people of Dunthrane rejoice that justice has been done. The adventurers receive their rewards and the adventurer champion receives and additional 1,500 experience points for individual merit.

After much celebrating. the council announces that Hollend has been elected regent of Dunador. The new regent then publicly acknowledges the great service the adventurers have done Dunador and announces that he will manage the realm until Edmund's 14 year-old, female cousin returns from a convent in the west. This young cousin, Valenria, will become the first queen of Dunador.

Pre-Rolled Player Characters

Bromley Falco

A talented illusionist-thief, this gnome wears leather armor and carries 12 darts. a dagger +1, thieves' tools, a potion of speed, and a ring of feather falling. He knows two 1st-level spells (at least one should be color spray) and one 2d-level spell.

Astrid Fyn

This human cleric wears chain mail and carries a shield. She also has a mace +1 and a quarterstaff. She carries a potion of healing and a potion of invisibility. She knows two 1st-level spells and two 2d-level spells.

Cameron Gaunt

This human ranger wears chain mail and carries a shield. He also uses a longsword +1, a composite bow with 20 arrows +1, a spear, and a flail.

Horses

In this outdoor adventure, mounted travel is essential. All the characters outlined on this page have light warhorses. Let the players roll hit points for their own horses.

6 light warhorses (AC 7; MV 24"; HD 2; #AT 2; D 1-4/1-4; S L; AL N).

Bromley Falco is unusually large for a gnome and so is able to manage a light horse with appropriate saddle modifications. This character cannot ride a large mount.

Owen Glendower

Owen is a half-elf fighter-cleric He wears chain mail ii and carries a shield, a long sword +1, a flail, a short bow, and a dagger. He also has a potion of extra healing. He knows two 1st-level spells and two 2d-level spells.

Horsa Hengist

This dwarf fighter wears plate mail and carries a shield. He also has a battle axe +1, a short sword, a crossbow, and a flail.

Kersana Ringlo

The elven magic-user wears bracers of defense AC 7 and has a +2 Dexterity bonus. giving her AC 5. She carries a 10-foot pole, a dagger +1, and a wand of paralyzation with 7 charges. She knows three 1st-level spells and two 2d-level spells.

Character	Race	Sex	AC	MV	Level	hp	AL	Str	Con	Dex	Int	Wis	Cha
Bromley Falco	G	M	6	12	I3/T4	17	LN	14	15	15	16	12	16
Astrid Fyn	H	F	4	9	C3	21	NG	15	14	15	14	16	13
Cameron Gaunt	H	M	3	9	F4	31	CG	16	17	16	14	12	14
Owen Glendower	HE	M	3	12	F3/C3	24	CG	16	14	15	11	16	13
Horsa Hengist	D	M	2	9	F3	32	LG	15	16	14	11	13	13
Kersana Ringlo	E	F	5	12	MU4	16	CN	13	14	16	17	11	17

Map 9A: Griffon Castle (ground level)

1 square = 10 feet

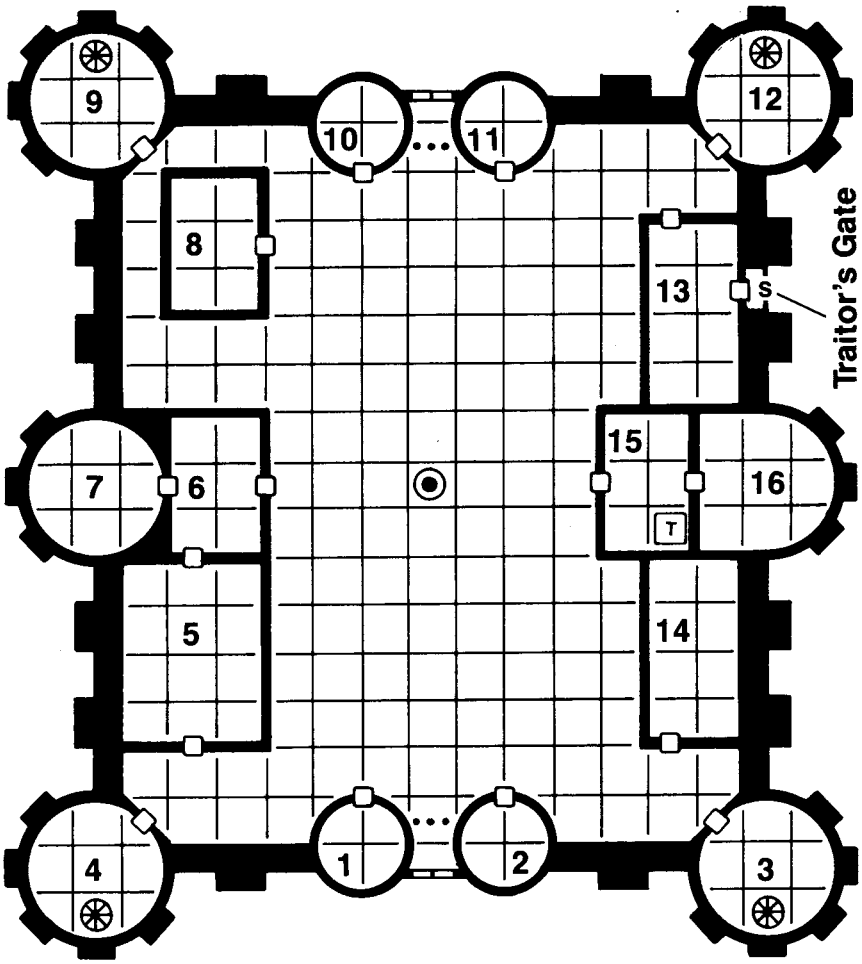
Spiral Stairs

Well

Portcullis

Trap Door in Flood

Note: all spiral stairs lead upward to their respective tower rooms directly above (no trap doors).



Map 9B: Griffon Castle (upper level)

1 square = 10 feet

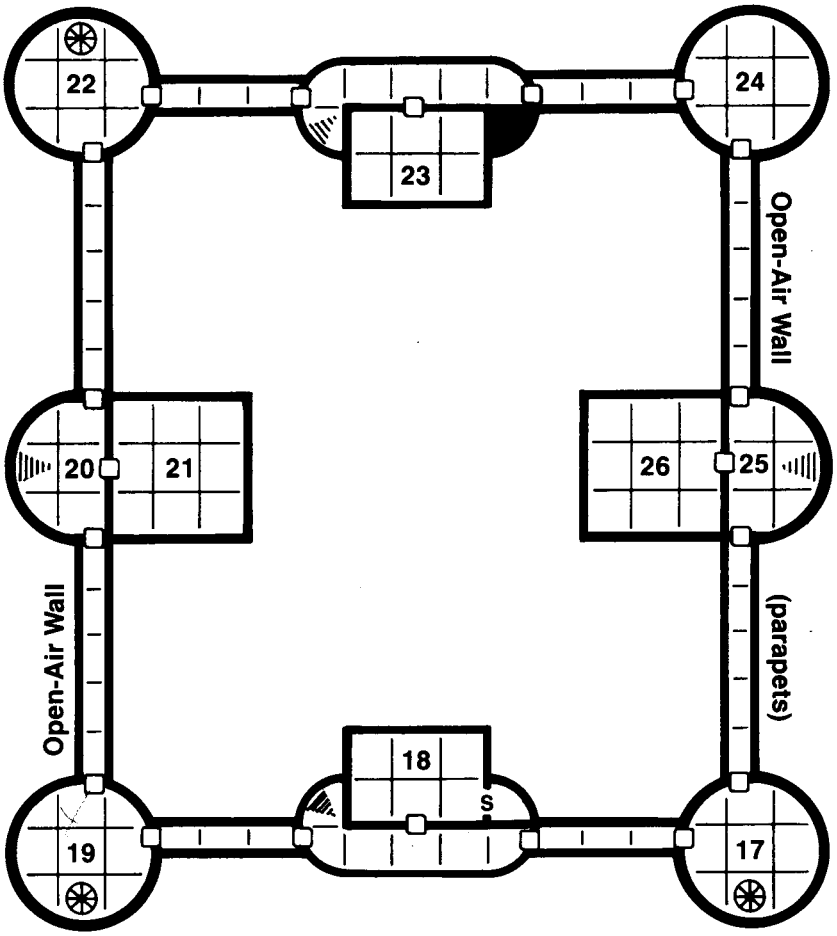
Spiral Stairs

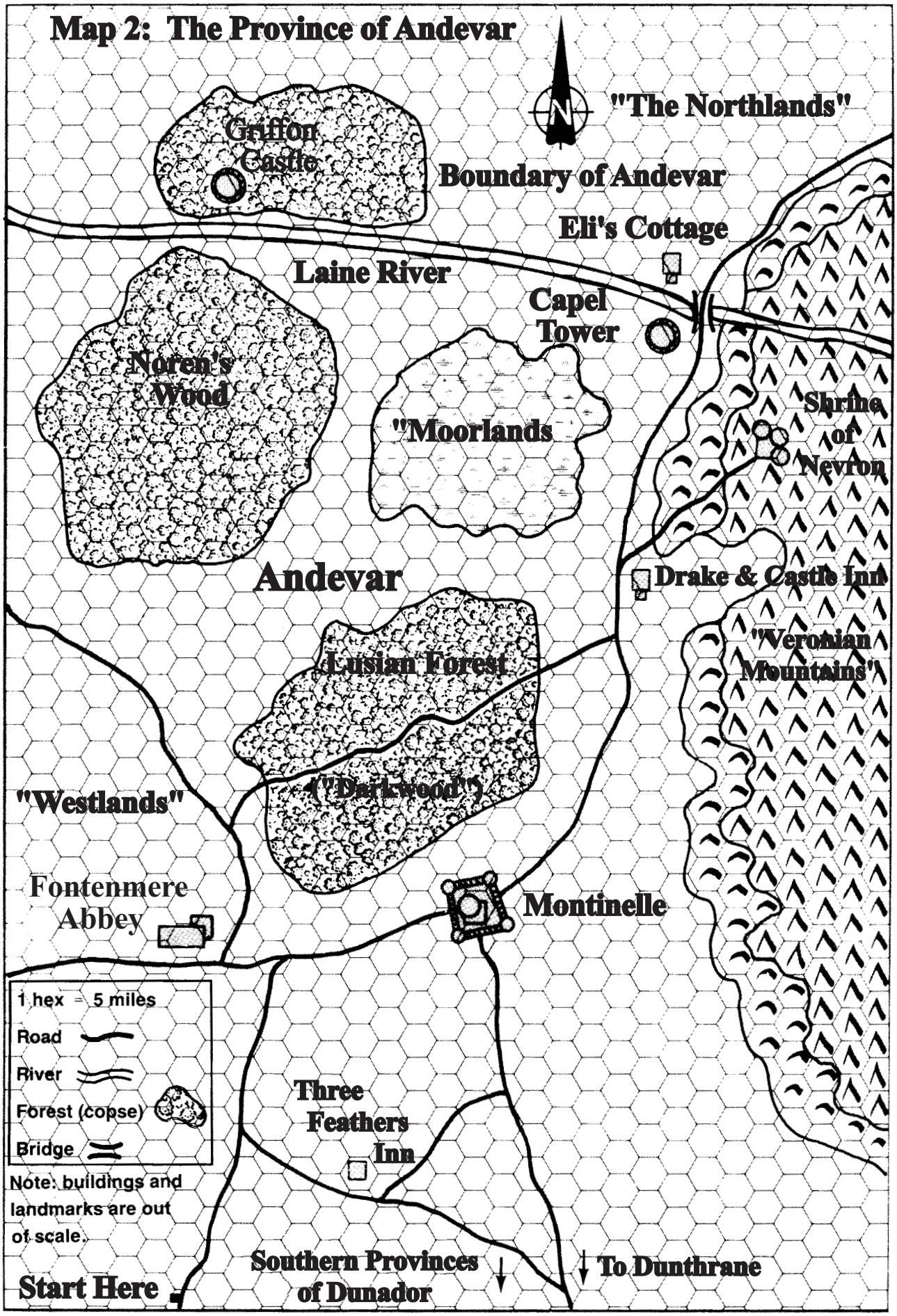
Well

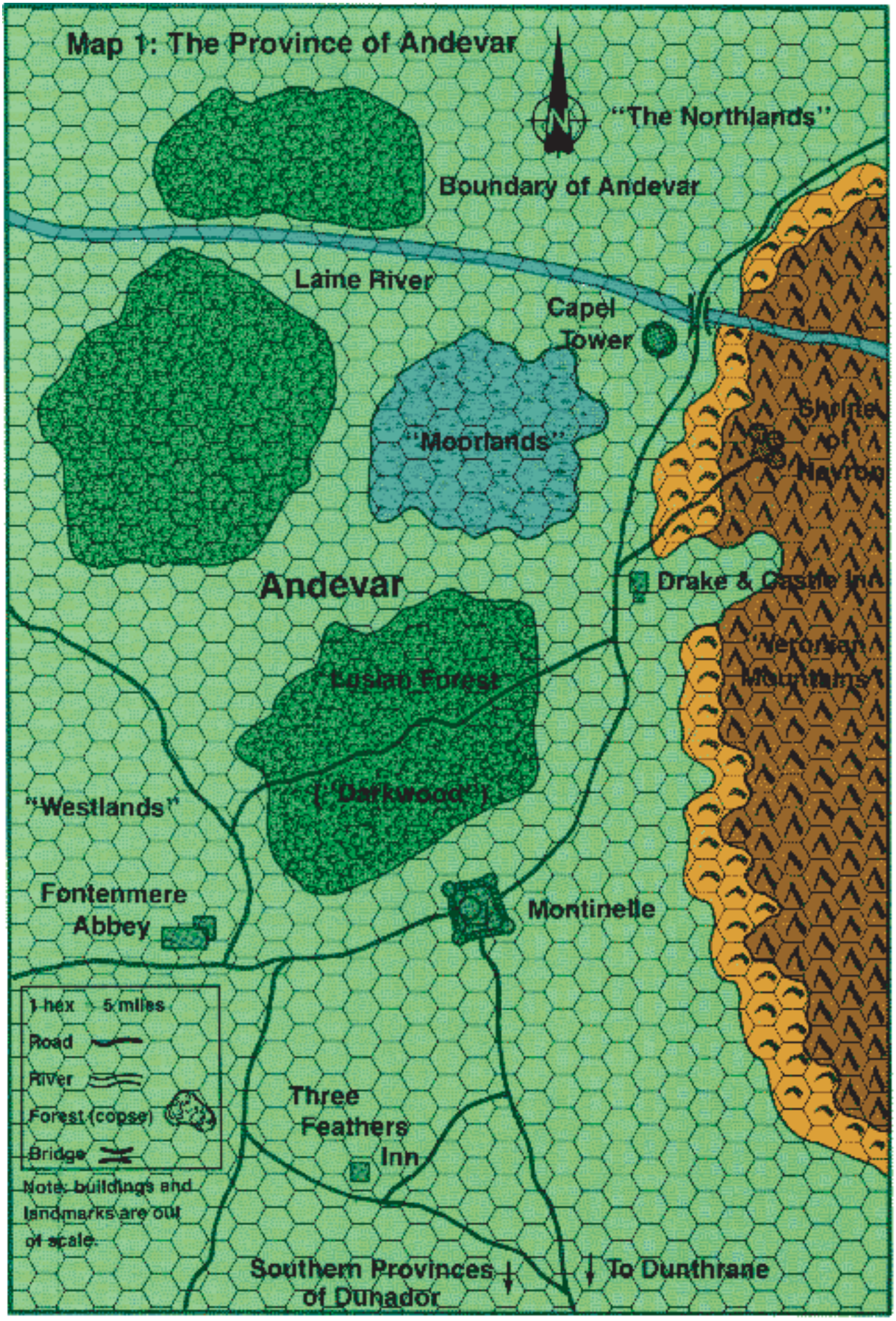
Walls are 40 feet high.

Towers are 50 feet high.

Note: each of the six towers and two gatehouses have open-air parapets above. All stairs and spiral stairs lead to trap doors and the parapets above.




Map 2: The Province of Andevar
N
"The Northlands"
Griffon Castle
Boundary of Andevar
Eli's Cottage
Laine River
Capel Tower
Noren's Wood
"Moorlands
Shrine of Nevron
Andevar
Drake & Castle Inn
"Veronian Mountains"
Lusian Forest
("Darkwood")
"Westlands"
Fontenmere Abbey
Montinelle
1 hex = 5 miles
Road
River
Forest (copse)
Bridge
Note: buildings and landmarks are out of scale.
Three Feathers Inn
Southern Provinces of Dunador
To Dunthrane
Start Here


Map 1: The Province of Andevar
N
"The Northlands"
Boundary of Andevar
Laine River
Capel Tower
"Moorlands"
Shrine of Nayrou
Andevar
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"Westlands"
Fontenmere Abbey
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1 hex = 5 miles
Road
River
Forest (copse)
Bridge
Note: buildings and landmarks are out of scale.
Three Feathers Inn
Southern Provinces of Dunador
To Dunthrane

Advanced Dungeons & Dragons

Official Game Adventure

Destiny of Kings

Stephen Bourne

When Treason Walks the Land...

The kingdom of Dunador is in trouble. Since the king, Halfred of Dunthrane, was killed in a hunting accident, the land has hovered on the brink of civil war. Crown Prince Edmund, at 18 only half-trained and quite unprepared to assume the throne, has yet to be crowned. Currently he is on a pilgrimage to the holy shrine of Nevron in the province of Andevar. While the uncrowned king is far from home, anarchy reigns in Dunador.

Throughout the realm, plots are brewing and evil hands are eagerly clutching at the sword of treason. Inevitably the focus of these intrigues is in the troubled province of Andevar to the north. For it is here that the young Prince has journeyed and here that he must be crowned.

In this dark hour Dunador has but one faithful servant: Hollend, chief advisor to the old king. Painfully aware of all that is at stake, Hollend has sought the aid of a brave party of adventurers in a desperate bid to tip the scales in favor of truth and justice. But, even as the party secretly enters Andevar, the forces of evil strike with blinding speed and ruthless determination.

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